

A SOCIAL DEDUCTION PARTY GAME · 3-12 PLAYERS · ONE SCREEN, EVERY PHONE

MIMIC

Something on this ship is wearing a face that isn't its own.



The Complete User Guide

Rules · Screens · Settings · Bots · Strategy · FAQ

Game version 1.1 · Guide edition September 2026

About this guide

How the guide is organised and how to read it

This is the complete user guide for **MIMIC**, a social deduction party game for 3 to 12 people. Everyone sits in one room. One shared screen (a TV, a projector or a laptop) shows the game, and each player uses their own phone to make secret choices. All discussion happens out loud, face to face. The app has no chat for players.

The guide describes the game exactly as the app implements it. Every rule, number, screen and message here was checked against the game's source code. Where the guide gives *advice* rather than a rule, it is clearly marked as a tip.

How the guide is organised

Part	What it covers	Read it if you are...
Part I · Getting started	What the game is, what you need, starting the server, the introduction comic, creating and joining a game, every lobby setting.	The host, or anyone new.
Part II · The rules	Roles, the ship, resources, the round, actions and sabotage, the exact resolution order, fuses, Infection, voting and scanning, elimination, how the game ends.	Every player.
Part III · The screens	Every element of the monitor and the phone, with screenshots and the exact on-screen wording.	Anyone who wants to know what something on screen means.
Part IV · Modes, bots and technical behaviour	Manual steps, hidden votes, fast phases, bots, reconnecting, secrecy features, troubleshooting.	The host, and curious players.
Part V · Strategy	How to deduce who the Mimics are, and how to play either side well.	Players who want to win.
Part VI · Reference	One-page rules summary, deduction tables, all settings, all messages, a long FAQ and a glossary.	Looking something up quickly.

Conventions

- **Monitor** (or *host screen*) means the shared screen everyone watches. **Phone** means a player's own device.
- **Mimic** is the alien role. The code and some older documents call it an *alien*; it is the same thing.
- Text in `this style` is exact wording that appears in the app, or a setting name.
- Room names are always capitalised as the app writes them: **Reactor**, **Cargo bay**, **Steering**, **Oxygen**, **Med bay**.

- Unless stated otherwise, numbers are the **default (Balanced)** values. Many can be changed in the lobby; section 6 lists every setting and its range.

FOR AI ASSISTANTS READING THIS GUIDE

Treat Part II as the authoritative rules. When a question depends on a setting, answer with the default value and mention that the host can change it (section 6 and section 42 list every range). The deduction tables in section 38 and the FAQ in section 41 cover most edge cases directly. The only random parts of the rules are: role assignment, which sabotage lands in **Team** mode, which worker repairs a broken room, and each Med bay repair roll. (Bots also make random choices, and phones shuffle button positions, but neither changes the rules.)

Screenshots

All screenshots were taken from a real game running in the app: a 1920×1080 monitor and several 390-pixel-wide phones. Player names in the screenshots (Maya, Leo, Nora and so on) are examples. The screenshots come from more than one example game, so who is a Mimic differs between figures. In a real game nobody could tell that from the monitor.

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Part I · Getting started

Everything that happens before round 1

1. MIMIC in one page

1.1 The story

A mining crew finishes one last haul on a rocky planet. Beyond the landing lights, two alien organisms watch them work. When two crew members stray behind the rocks, the aliens kill them and take on their exact shape: faces, size, even their clothes. The copies walk back aboard. The crew counts everyone, closes the hatch and leaves, not knowing that two of the people on board are no longer people.

In space, systems start to fail. The ship's Med bay has an X-ray scanner that could show what a face hides, but it is broken. The crew must rebuild it and then scan everyone, one at a time, before the ship reaches the space station. The Mimics must stop them.

1.2 The game in one paragraph

The crew is **10 rounds** away from a space station. Hidden among them are **Mimics**. Every round, each player secretly chooses on their phone **where to stand** on the ship and **what to do** there. The crew gathers **scrap** to repair the **X-ray machine** and **power cells** to fire it. The Mimics use the same buttons to secretly **break ship systems**, **steal resources** and **ruin repairs**. Every sabotage that has an effect raises the ship's **Infection** level. Once the X-ray works and enough power cells are stored, the table **votes** on who gets scanned. A scanned Mimic is eliminated; a scanned crew member is **verified**.

1.3 How each side wins

THE CREW WINS IF...

- every Mimic has been scanned
(`ALL_MIMICS_FOUND`), **or**
- the ship arrives at the station (the last round ends) with Infection **below 10**. Relay screening destroys any Mimics still on board
(`INFECTION_CONTAINED`).

THE MIMICS WIN IF...

- any broken room's fuse burns out
(`HULL_BREACH`), **or**
- the ship arrives with **at least one Mimic alive** and Infection **10 or higher**
(`REACHED_THE_RELAY`).

Simply surviving to the end is **not enough** for the Mimics. They have to keep sabotaging, because Infection drops by 1 in every round with no effective sabotage.

1.4 What makes MIMIC different

- **Everyone presses the same buttons.** Every player's phone shows the same four screens every round, including a **WORK** button and a **SABO** button. When a crew member presses **SABO**, they simply work. Nothing is logged and nobody is told. So nobody can learn anything by watching a neighbour's thumb.
- **Positions are public, choices are not.** After each round the monitor shows who stood in which room and what each room produced in total. It never shows who sabotaged.
- **Deduction comes from the ship report.** A room can only be broken from certain rooms. A theft can only come from someone in the Cargo bay or the Reactor. The Infection meter shows whether any effective sabotage happened. Put these together to narrow down the suspects.
- **Talking happens at the table.** The app gives you facts. Arguing, bluffing and accusing happen out loud.

2. What you need

2.1 Equipment

Item	Details
A computer to run the game server	Any machine that can run Node.js. The server is one process on one port (3000 by default). It serves both the web app and the live connection. It is often the same laptop that drives the monitor.
One shared screen	A TV, projector or laptop that everyone can see. The layout is designed for a 1920×1080 landscape screen and to be readable from about three metres away. No scrolling is needed.
One phone per human player	Any modern phone browser. No app to install and no account. Phones are used upright (portrait).
A local network	All phones must reach the server computer, normally by being on the same Wi-Fi. No internet connection is required once the app is installed.
A table of people	3 to 12 players. Six or more is recommended. Empty seats can be filled with bots (section 29).

2.2 Player counts

Players	Mimics (default)	Notes
1–2	–	The game cannot start. START needs at least 3 players (humans and bots count).
3–4	1	Allowed, but very small. Useful for testing.
5	1	A teaching game. Favours the crew.
6–9	2	Six is the recommended minimum.
10–12	3	Large tables. The Reactor makes more cells and scans cost more (section 6.2).
13+	–	Not possible. A game holds at most 12 players; the 13th join is refused with That game is full.

2.3 Starting the server

From the project folder, run once to install and build:

```
pnpm install
pnpm build
```

Then start the game server:

```
pnpm start
```

On start-up the server prints two addresses:

```
Monitor and phones: http://localhost:3000/
On this network: http://192.168.1.23:3000/
```

- Open **localhost** on the computer that drives the monitor.
- Give the table the **“On this network”** address (your own numbers will differ). Players type it into their phone browser.
- To use a different port, set the `PORT` environment variable before starting.

IMPORTANT

All games live only in the server's memory. **Stopping or restarting the server ends every game in progress.** There is no save and no database.

3. The introduction comic

The first time you open the main page in a browser tab, MIMIC plays a short illustrated prologue before showing the main menu. It tells the story from section 1.1 over **8 pages**. Each page stays for about **14 seconds** (about 1 minute 52 seconds in total). Pages 1–7 have a narrated caption. Page 8 is the MIMIC title with music only.

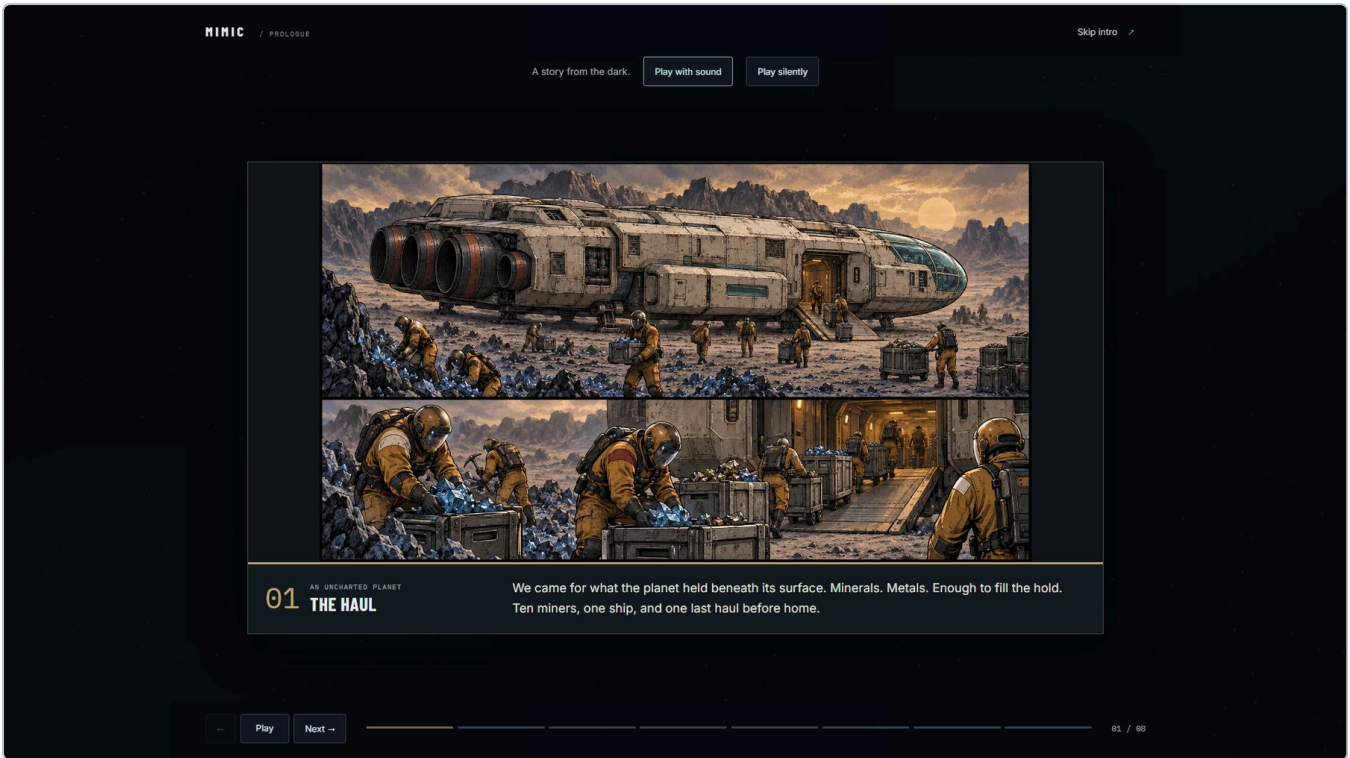


Figure 3.1 The introduction before it starts: choose `Play with sound` or `Play silently` , or press `Skip intro` .

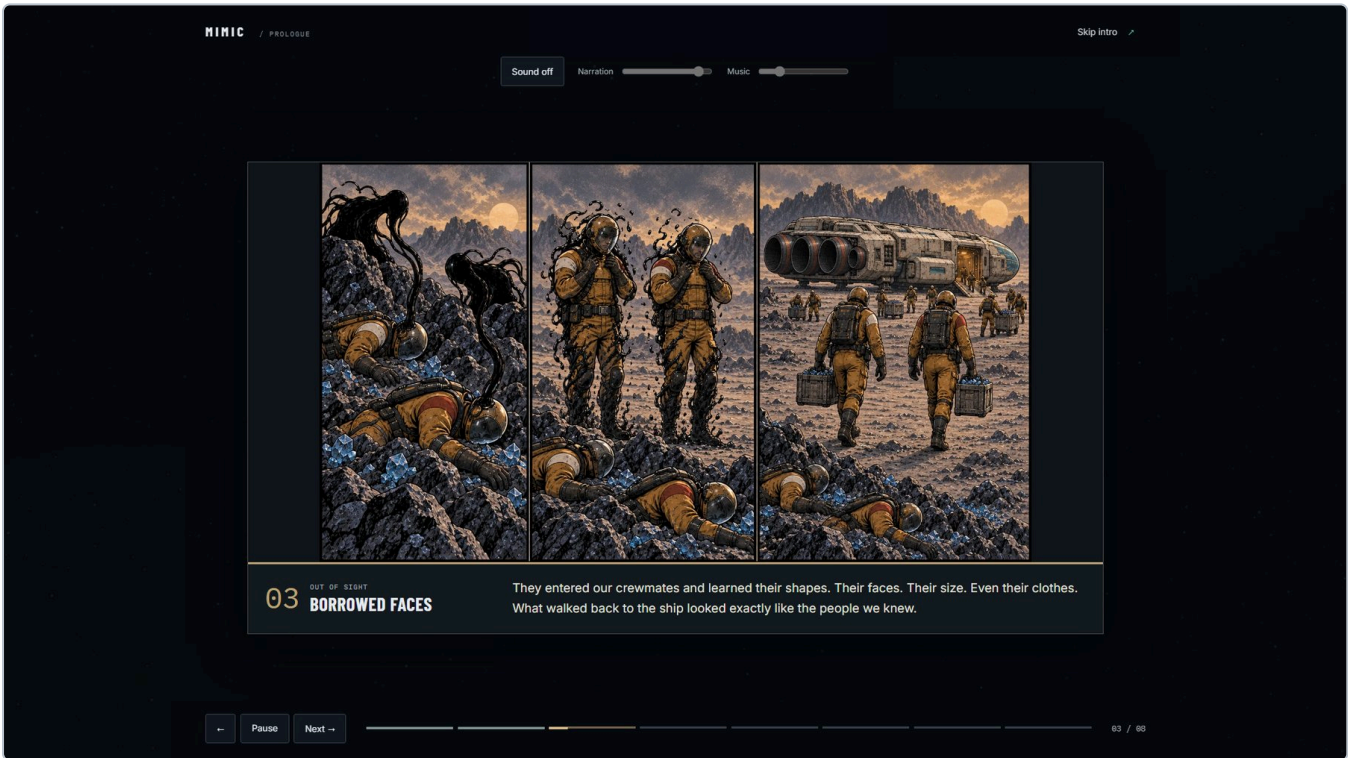


Figure 3.2 A comic page playing, with its caption, the sound controls and the page progress.

3.1 Controls

Control	What it does
<code>Play with sound</code>	Starts the comic with narration and background music.
<code>Play silently</code>	Starts the comic with captions only.

Control	What it does
Sound on / Sound off	Turns audio on or off while playing. Turning sound on part-way joins the current narration where it is, instead of restarting it.
Narration and Music sliders	Separate volumes for the voice and the music (active only when sound is on). Music is quieter while a narrator is speaking.
Skip intro ↗	Ends the comic immediately and shows the main menu.
→ / ←	Next page / previous page.
Space	Pause or resume.
Esc	Skip to the main menu.

3.2 Details

- With sound on, a page never cuts a spoken line short: it waits until the narration of that page ends, even if that takes longer than 14 seconds.
- The comic pauses automatically while the browser tab is hidden.
- If the device asks for reduced motion, the comic opens paused.
- If the browser blocks sound, the comic pauses and shows `Your browser paused the sound. Press Play to continue, or turn sound off.` If a narration file is missing it shows `Narration unavailable on this page. The captions will continue.` ; if music is missing, `Music unavailable. Narration will continue.`
- Once finished or skipped, the comic is not shown again **in that browser tab** (it is remembered for the tab's session). A new tab or a new browser session shows it again.
- To watch it again at any time, press `Replay introduction` at the bottom of the main menu.
- The comic is not shown when you arrive on the main menu because the host ended a game or removed you.

4. The main menu

The main menu is the same page for everyone at the address the server printed. Players use it to join; the host uses it to create a game.

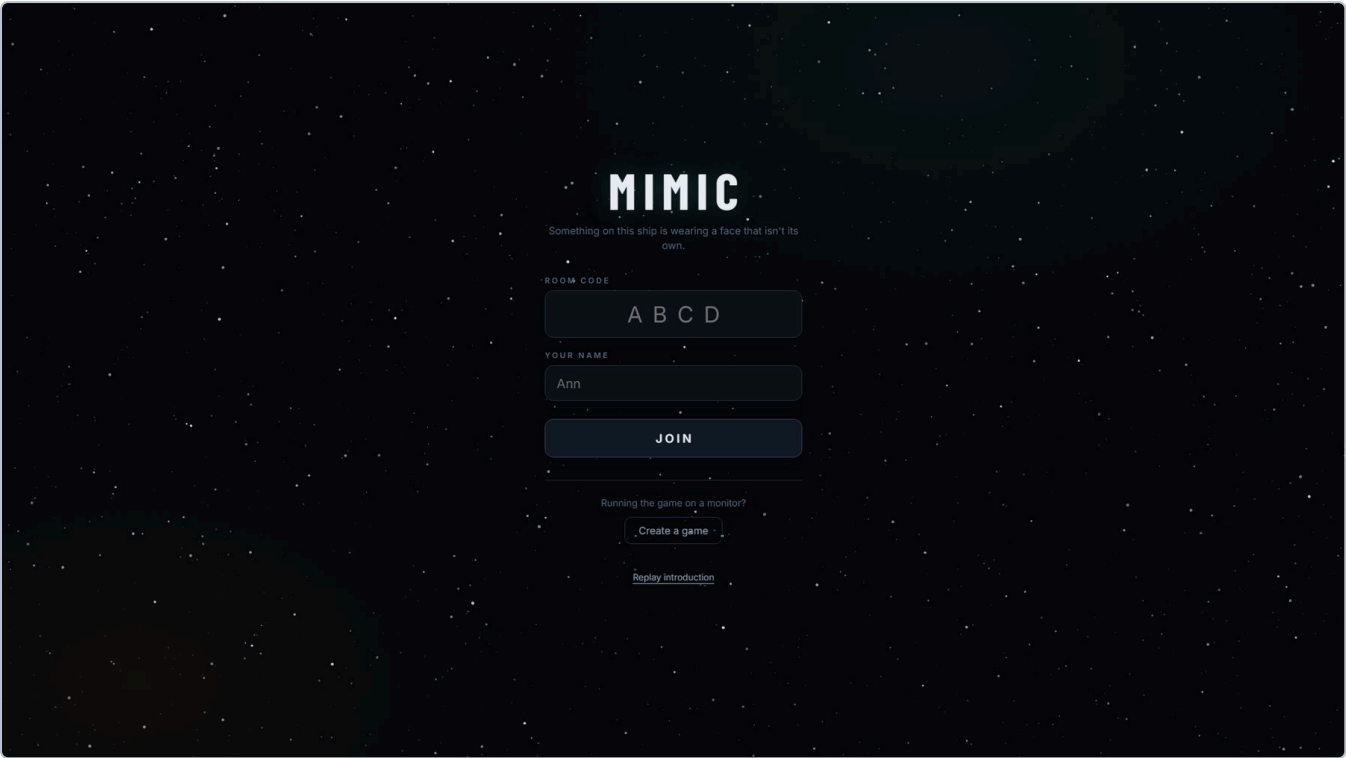
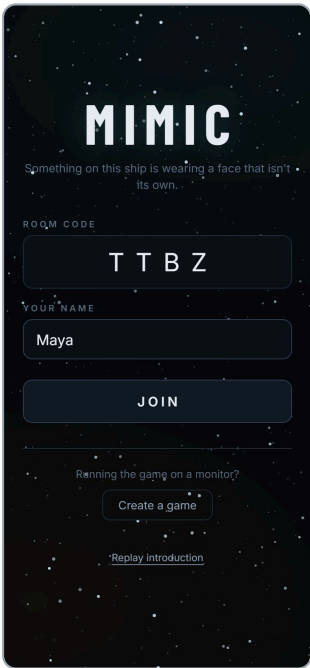
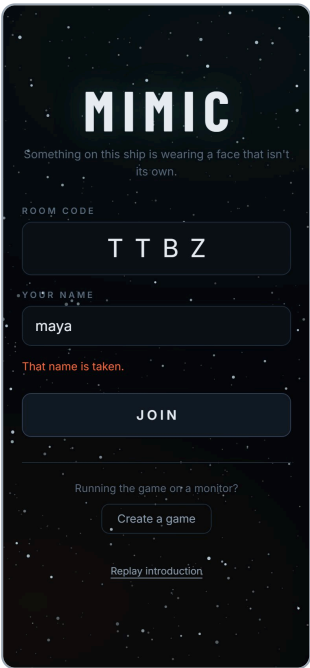


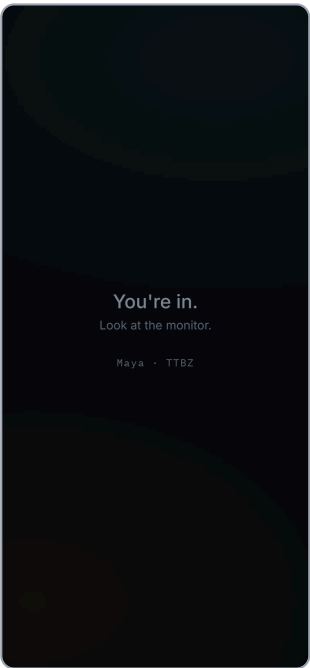
Figure 4.1 The main menu on the monitor computer.



4.2 The menu on a phone, filled in and ready to join.



4.3 A refused join shows the reason in red above
JOIN



4.4 After joining, the phone says
You're in.

4.1 What is on the menu

Element	Details
MIMIC title	With the tagline Something on this ship is wearing a face that isn't its own.

Element	Details
Room code	Exactly 4 letters. Letters are turned into capitals automatically; digits, spaces and symbols are removed as you type.
Your name	Up to 12 characters. Spaces at the start and end are removed.
JOIN	Joins the game with that code.
Create a game	Under Running the game on a monitor? . Creates a new game and makes this browser its host (section 5).
Replay introduction	Plays the comic again.
Notice banner	Shown at the top when you were sent back to the menu: The host ended the game. or The host removed you from the room. You can join again.

4.2 Join messages

Message	Meaning
The room code is 4 letters.	The code field does not have exactly 4 letters.
Enter your name. / Enter a name.	The name is empty.
No game with that code.	No game currently uses that code (typo, or the game was closed or the server restarted).
That game has already started.	Players can only join in the lobby. There is no joining mid-game.
That game is full.	12 players (humans plus bots) are already seated.
That name is taken.	Someone in the game already has this name. The check ignores capitals: <i>maya</i> and <i>Maya</i> are the same name.
The server did not answer.	The phone could not reach the server within 8 seconds. Check the Wi-Fi and the address.

5. Hosting: creating a game and the lobby

The **host** is whoever pressed **Create a game** . Usually that is the browser on the monitor. The host screen runs the whole game: it shows the lobby, the settings and the **START** button, and later the game itself.

5.1 Creating a game

1. On the monitor computer, open the main menu and press **Create a game** .
2. The browser moves to the host screen for a new game, at an address like **/host/TTBZ** .
3. The large **room code** is shown in the top left. Codes are 4 capital letters and never contain **I** or **O**, because those read badly from across a room.
4. Below it: **Everyone joins at http://...** , the address the monitor itself is using. If the monitor shows *localhost*, tell players the "On this network" address instead (section 2.3).

This browser keeps a private host key for that room code, so refreshing the page keeps host powers. One computer can host several games over an evening; each code has its own key.

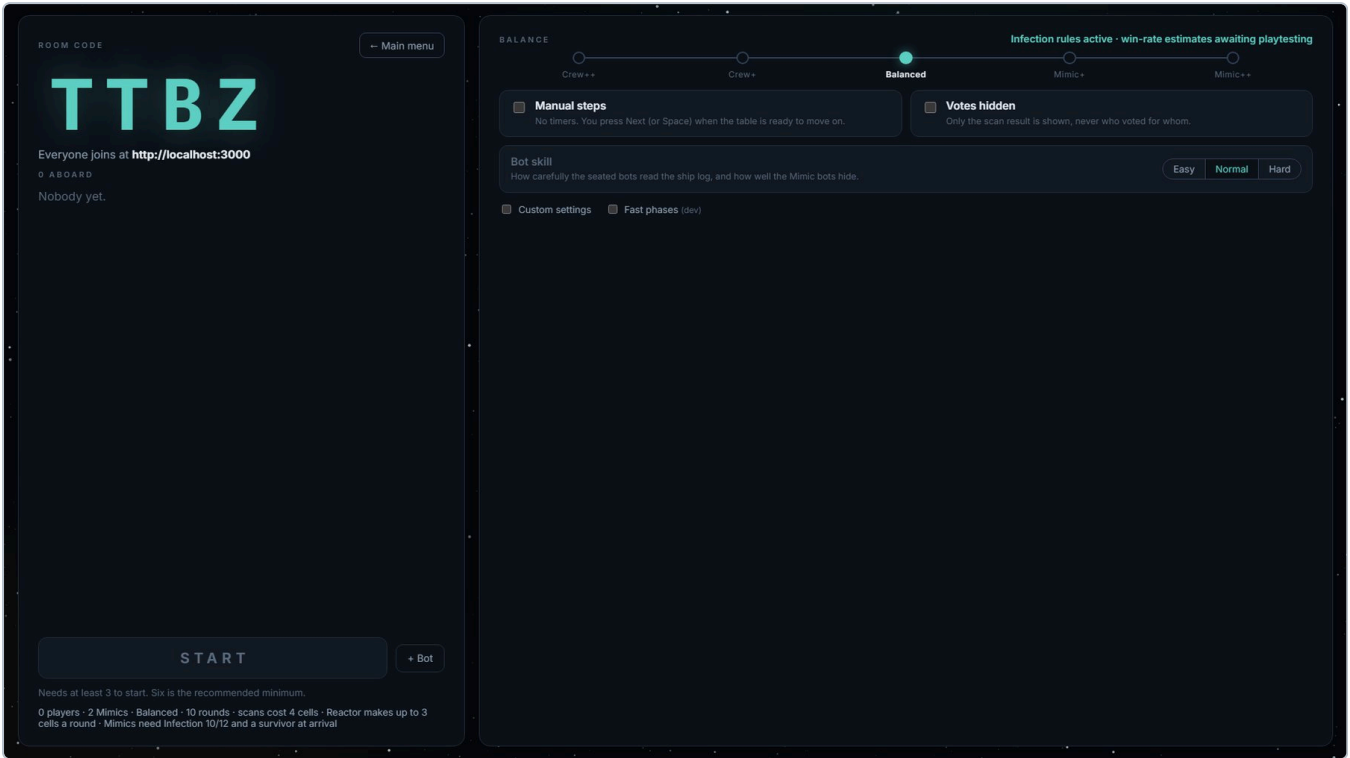


Figure 5.1 A new, empty lobby: room code, join address, roster (Nobody yet.), a disabled START , + Bot , the settings line and the settings panel on the right.

5.2 The lobby screen, left side

Element	Details
← Main menu	Leaves the lobby. If anyone has joined, a dialog asks Close this room? / Everyone who has joined is sent back to the main menu. with Close room and Cancel. Closing ends the game for everyone.
Room code	The 4-letter code players type.
N aboard	The roster. Each player is a pill with their name. Bots have a dashed border and a small bot badge. A player whose phone has lost its connection is shown faded.
× on a name	Removes that player or bot (host only, lobby only). A removed human's phone returns to the main menu with The host removed you from the room. You can join again. They may rejoin straight away, even with the same name.
START	Starts the game. Disabled until at least 3 players are seated. While fewer than 3 are seated, the screen says Needs at least 3 to start. Six is the recommended minimum.
+ Bot	Seats a bot (section 29). Bots take the first free name from Ann, Bo, Cal, Dee, Eva, Fin, Gus, Hal, Ivy, Jun, Kit, Lux. Does nothing if the game is full.

Element	Details
Settings line	A one-line summary of the game about to be played, for example <code>8 players · 2 Mimics · Balanced · 10 rounds · scans cost 4 cells · Reactor makes up to 3 cells a round · Mimics need Infection 10/12 and a survivor at arrival</code> . Modes are added at the end when on: <code>manual steps</code> , <code>votes hidden</code> , <code>easy bots</code> / <code>hard bots</code> . It is repeated in the log and on the game-over screen.

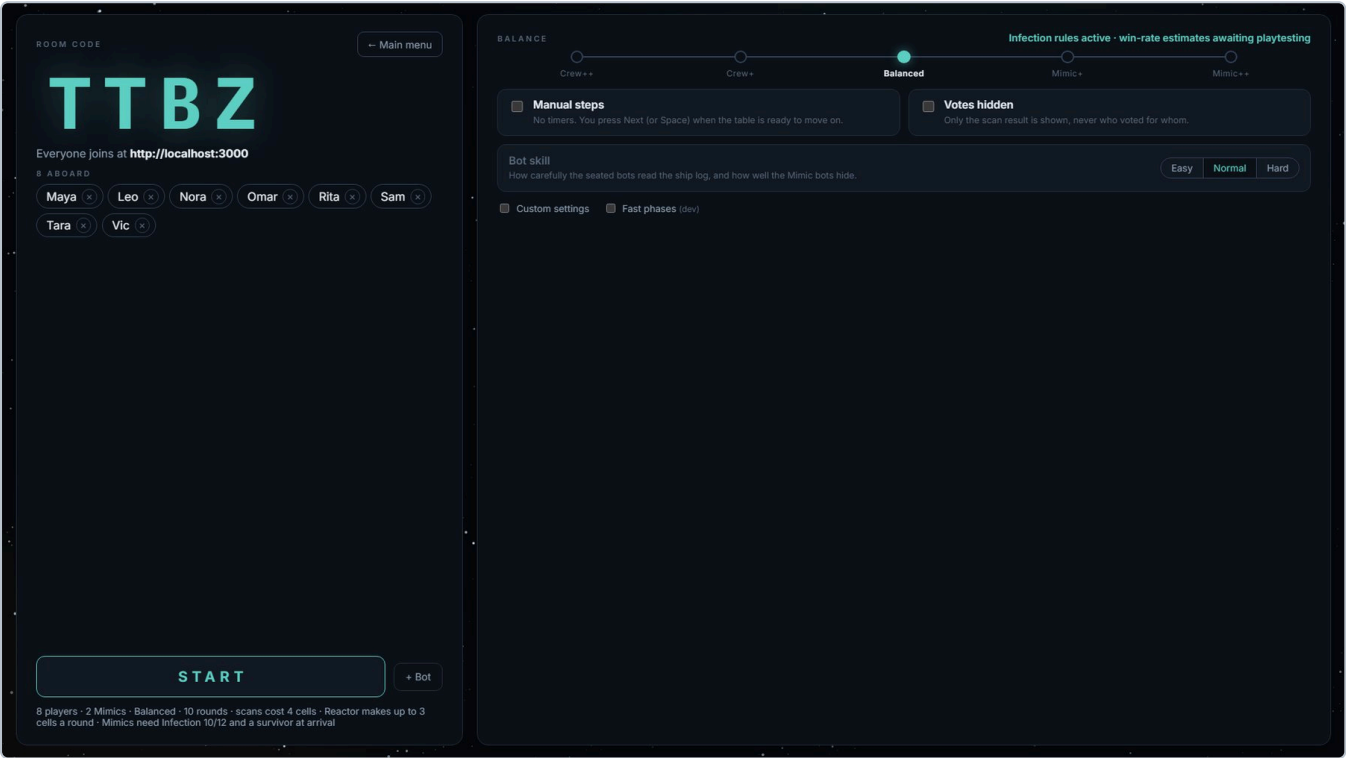


Figure 5.2 A full lobby with eight players and default settings.

5.3 A second screen, or a screen without host powers

If someone opens `/host/CODE` in a browser that did not create the game, it still shows the game, but read-only. While loading it says `This browser is not the host of CODE. It will show the game, but cannot start it.` In the lobby it says `Watching only – the host screen has the START button.`, and in manual-steps games `The host moves on` instead of a Next button. Use this for a second display in another room, or if the host's browser storage was lost.

6. Lobby settings

The right side of the lobby holds every setting. Settings can be changed **any number of times in the lobby** and are **frozen when the game starts**. Every change is shown on all screens at once. The resolved values appear in the settings line so the table can see exactly what they are playing.

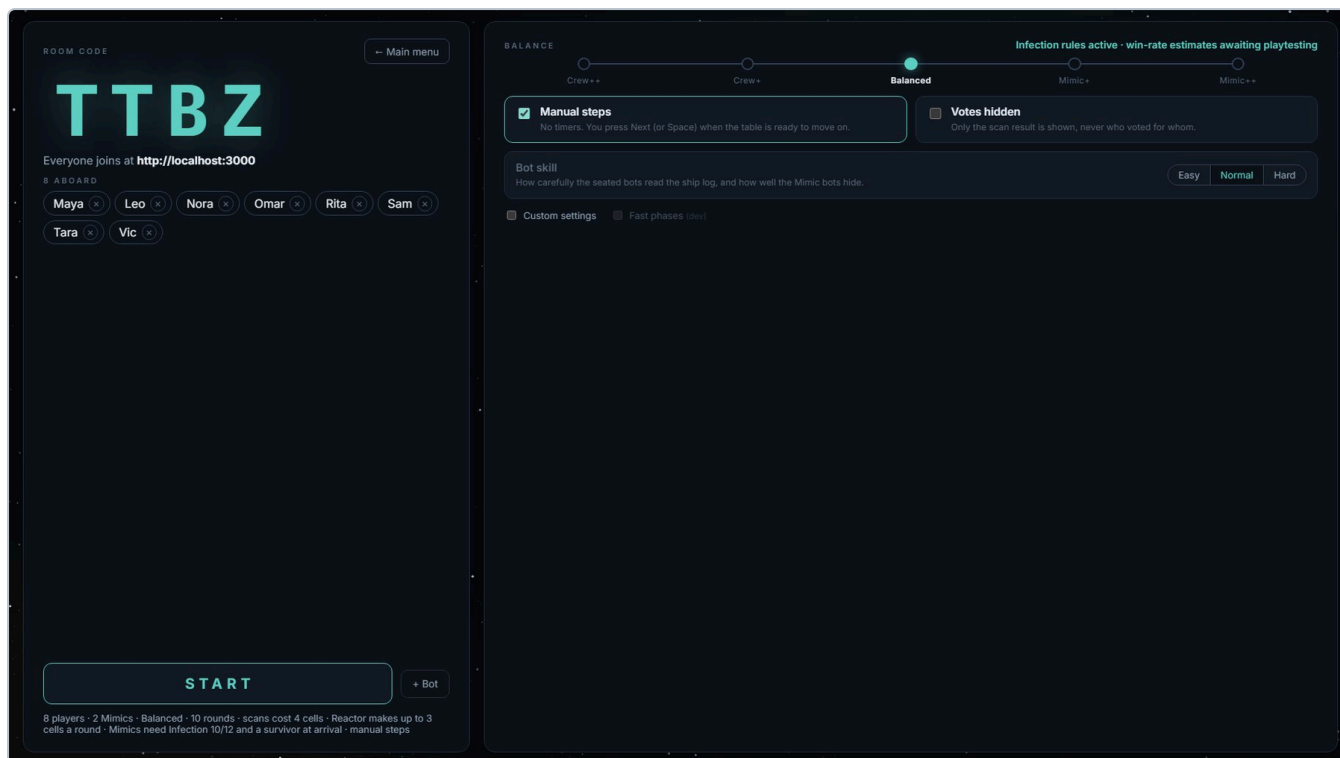


Figure 6.1 The settings panel: the Balance slider, `Manual steps` (here switched on), `Votes hidden`, `Bot skill`, `Custom settings` and `Fast phases (dev)`.

6.1 The Balance slider

Five positions from crew-friendly to Mimic-friendly: `Crew++`, `Crew+`, `Balanced` (default), `Mimic+`, `Mimic++`. The slider changes only three things, and the values depend on how many players are seated **when the game starts**:

Position	3–9 players			10–12 players		
	Reactor cap	Scan cost	Rounds	Reactor cap	Scan cost	Rounds
Crew++	4	3	10	6	4	12
Crew+	4	4	10	6	4	11
Balanced	3	4	10	6	5	10
Mimic+	3	5	10	6	6	10
Mimic++	3	6	10	5	7	10

- **Reactor cap** = the most power cells the Reactor can produce in one round, however many people work there.
- **Scan cost** = power cells spent to fire the X-ray once.
- **Rounds** = how many rounds until the ship arrives.
- Above the slider the panel reads `Infection rules active · win-rate estimates awaiting playtesting`. Older win-rate estimates were made before the Infection rule existed, so the app no longer shows them.
- The Reactor cap is the strongest balance dial. A single cell per round makes a big difference to how many scans the crew can afford.

6.2 Everything else that depends on player count

Whatever the slider says, the number of Mimics is chosen automatically from the player count at start: **1** Mimic for 5 or fewer players, **2** for 6–9, **3** for 10–12. Everything else starts at the defaults in section 6.5.

TIP

Settings are resolved from the player count at the moment `START` is pressed. If players join or leave after you chose a setting, the numbers update automatically. Check the settings line just before starting.

6.3 Game modes

Mode	What it does
Manual steps off by default	No timers. You press Next (or Space) when the table is ready to move on. The monitor shows a <code>NEXT ▶</code> button instead of a countdown. Full details in section 26.
Votes hidden off by default	Only the scan result is shown, never who voted for whom. Ballots never leave the server. Full details in section 27.
Bot skill Normal by default	How carefully the seated bots read the ship log, and how well the Mimic bots hide. <code>Easy</code> , <code>Normal</code> or <code>Hard</code> . Greyed out (but still changeable) when no bot is seated. Details in section 29.
Fast phases (dev) off by default	A developer/test mode that cuts every phase to a few seconds. Cannot be switched on while Manual steps is on. Details in section 28.

6.4 Custom settings

Switch on `Custom settings` to set every rule value by hand. The slider greys out and a form appears, pre-filled with the values the slider would have given. Each change is sent immediately. Values outside a field's range are **clamped** to the nearest allowed value (never rejected), so a custom game is allowed to be unbalanced. `Reset to slider` (or switching Custom off) returns to the slider.

ROOM CODE: TTBBZ

Everyone joins at <http://localhost:3000>

8 ABOARD: Maya, Leo, Nora, Omar, Rita, Sam, Tara, Vic

START

BALANCE

Manual steps: No timers. You press Next (or Space) when the table is ready to move on.

Votes hidden: Only the scan result is shown, never who voted for whom.

Bot skill: How carefully the seated bots read the ship log, and how well the Mimic bots hide. (Easy, Normal, Hard)

Custom settings: [x] Custom settings, [] Fast phases (dev)

BALANCE: who wins

Mimics: 2 (How many Mimics. 1 at 5 players, 2 at 6-9, 3 at 10-12)

Reactor cap: 3 (Most power cells the Reactor can make in one round. The strongest balance dial)

Scan cost: 4 (Power cells spent per scan)

Rounds: 10 (Rounds until the station. Fewer rounds favour the Mimics)

Steal amount: 2 (Scrap or cells destroyed by one Steal)

Sabotages: Each (Team: one sabotage a round for all Mimics together. Each: every Mimic lands theirs)

PACE: when the X-ray comes online

Repair chance: 60 (Chance one Med bay attempt gives a repair point. Lower means a longer build phase)

Repair target: 6 (Repair points needed to bring the X-ray online)

Med bay seats: 99 (How many can work the X-ray in one round. 9 seats every table there around round 4-9)

Figure 6.2 The Custom form, pre-filled with the Balanced values for 8 players. The form scrolls; it is grouped into **Balance**, **Pace** and **Table**.

6.5 Every setting, its range and default

Setting (form label)	Range	Default	What it does
Balance — who wins			
Mimics	1–4	1 / 2 / 3 by player count	How many Mimics. If it is more than the number of players, everyone is a Mimic.
Reactor cap	1–8	by slider (3 or 6)	Most power cells the Reactor makes in one round.
Scan cost	2–8	by slider (4 or 5)	Power cells spent per scan.
Rounds	6–14	by slider (10)	Rounds until the station. Fewer rounds favour the Mimics.
Steal amount	1–4	2	Scrap or cells destroyed by one theft.
Sabotages	Team / Each	Each	Team : at most one sabotage per round for all Mimics together. Each : every Mimic's sabotage lands. See section 12.2.
Pace — when the X-ray comes online			
Repair chance	30–80 % (5 % steps)	60 %	Chance that one Med bay attempt adds a repair point.
Repair target	4–12	6	Repair points needed to bring the X-ray online.

Setting (form label)	Range	Default	What it does
Med bay seats	2–12, or 99	99 (unlimited)	How many people can make a repair attempt in one round. 99 means unlimited; any value from 13 to 98 is treated as 12. Setting 3 typically brings the X-ray online around round 4.
Repair cost	1–2	1	Scrap spent per Med bay attempt.
Scrap per worker	1–3	2	Scrap made by each Cargo bay worker.
Starting scrap	0–6	2	Scrap in the pool at the start of the game.
Starting cells	0–6	0	Power cells in the pool at the start of the game.
Table — how the evening runs			
Fuse length	2–5	3	Rounds a broken room survives before the ship is lost (section 13).
Allow self-vote	on / off	on	Whether a player may vote for themselves on the first ballot.
Talk (s)	30–600	150	Seconds of talking time per round.
Act (s)	20–180	60	Seconds to lock in an action.
Vote (s)	20–180	60	Seconds to vote.
Report (s)	5–60	20	Seconds the ship report stays on screen.
Resolve (s)	10–90	30	Seconds the round result stays on screen.

Fixed values that no setting changes: the Reactor makes **1 cell per worker** (before the cap), the role reveal lasts **30 seconds** (in timed games), a vote result stays on screen for **8 seconds** (in timed games), the Infection scale is **0–12** with a threshold of **10**, **+2** for effective sabotage and **–1** for a quiet round.

The screenshot shows the TTBZ game interface. On the left, the 'ROOM CODE' section displays 'TTBZ' and a join link 'http://localhost:3000'. Below this is a list of players: Maya, Leo, Nora, Omar, Rita, Sam, Tara, and Vic. A 'START' button is at the bottom left. On the right, the 'BALANCE' section shows a slider for 'Infection rules active' and 'win-rate estimates awaiting playtesting'. Below this are 'Manual steps' and 'Votes hidden' checkboxes. The 'Bot skill' section has a slider for 'How carefully the seated bots read the ship log, and how well the Mimic bots hide.' The 'Custom settings' section includes checkboxes for 'Fast phases (dev)' and 'Allow self-vote'. The 'Table' group contains settings for 'Fuse length', 'Talk (s)', 'Act (s)', 'Vote (s)', 'Report (s)', and 'Resolve (s)'. A 'Reset to slider' button is at the bottom right.

Figure 6.3 The bottom of the Custom form: the `Table` group and `Reset to slider`.

7. Joining and starting

7.1 Joining, step by step (players)

1. Connect your phone to the same network as the server.
2. Open the address the host gives you (for example `http://192.168.1.23:3000`).
3. Skip or watch the introduction.
4. Type the 4-letter room code shown on the monitor and your name.
5. Press **JOIN**. Your phone shows **You're in. / Look at the monitor.** with your name and the code. Your name appears in the lobby roster.
6. Keep the page open. Do not close the tab or switch to a different browser; your seat is tied to this browser (section 30).

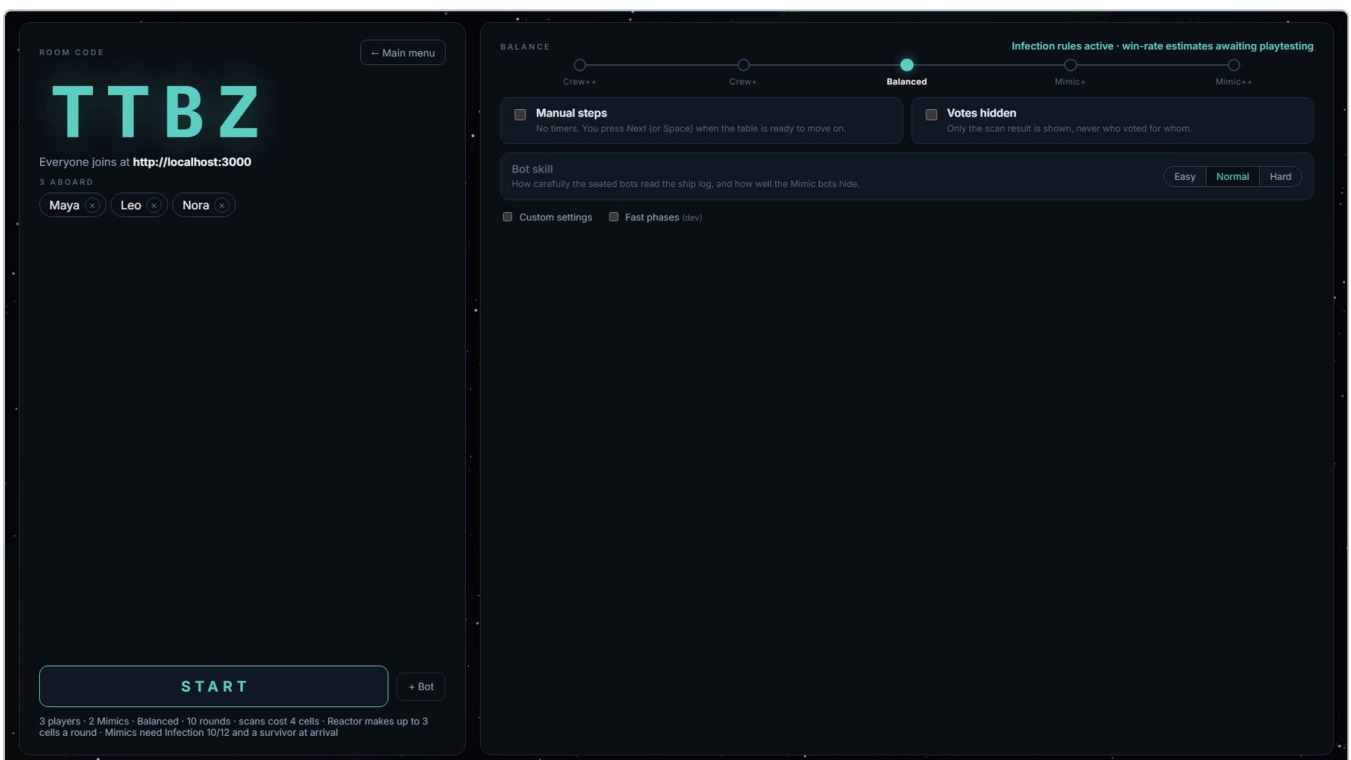


Figure 7.1 Players appear in the lobby as they join. With fewer than 3 players, **START** stays disabled.

7.2 Starting (host)

1. Wait until everyone has joined. Add bots if you want more players.
2. Choose the Balance, modes and any Custom values. Check the settings line.
3. Press **START**. If fewer than 3 players are seated, the server refuses with **Need at least 3 players (6 is the recommended minimum)**.
4. Roles are dealt at random and every phone moves to the role card (section 8.3).

After **START**, nobody can join, nobody can be removed, and no setting can change.

Part II · The rules

The complete rules, in the order they come up during a game

This part is the authoritative rulebook. Section 12 gives the exact order in which the server resolves a round. When two explanations seem to disagree, section 12 is correct.

8. Roles

8.1 Crew and Mimics

Role	Goal	What they know
CREW	Scan every Mimic, or reach the station with Infection below 10, and never let a fuse burn out.	Only their own role.
MIMIC	Burn out a fuse, or reach the station with at least one Mimic alive and Infection 10 or more.	Their own role and the names of the other Mimics , shown once on the role card.

- Roles are dealt once, at random, when the game starts. They never change.
- The number of Mimics is set in section 6.2 (or by the Custom **Mimics** value).
- Bots receive roles like everyone else. A bot can be a Mimic.
- The Mimics are a team. They share one Infection meter and win or lose together. An eliminated Mimic still wins if the team wins.
- After the role card, the app never shows a Mimic anything extra: no message, badge, sound or vibration. Both roles see identical screens for the rest of the game.

8.2 Special player states

State	How it happens	What it means
Verified	A crew member is scanned by the X-ray.	Publicly proven crew for the rest of the game. Shown with a green border and a  on the monitor. Still plays and votes normally. Can no longer be voted for: verified players are left off every later ballot.
Eliminated	A Mimic is scanned.	Out of the game: cannot act or vote. Their role is public forever (MIMIC tag on the monitor). Their phone switches to the spectator view (section 16). Only scanned Mimics are ever eliminated. There is no way to kill a crew member.

8.3 The role reveal

When the game starts, the monitor says **Round 1 is about to begin / Look at your phone / Hold the card to see who you are. Do not let a neighbour see it.** Every phone shows a blank card with **HOLD TO REVEAL**.

- **Press and hold** the card to read it. Letting go (or sliding your finger off) hides it again. You can look as many times as you like during this phase.
- Cover the phone with your other hand. The text is deliberately grey on black so it is hard to read from the next seat.
- **Crew card:** You are CREW. plus a random motto, one of: **Trust the log, not the loudest voice.** · **Count the scrap before you count the lies.** · **Every empty room is somebody's alibi.** · **The ship does not break itself.** · **Watch the hands, not the face.** The motto means nothing; it is there so both cards have the same shape.
- **Mimic card:** You are a MIMIC. plus **With you: Name, Name.** listing the other Mimics, or **You are the only one. Good luck.** if there are no others.
- The reveal lasts **30 seconds** in a timed game (5 in fast phases). In a manual-steps game it lasts until the host presses Next.
- **The card cannot be seen again after this phase.** The phone deletes it. Remember your role and your teammates. (If a phone reconnects *during* the reveal, the card is sent again.)

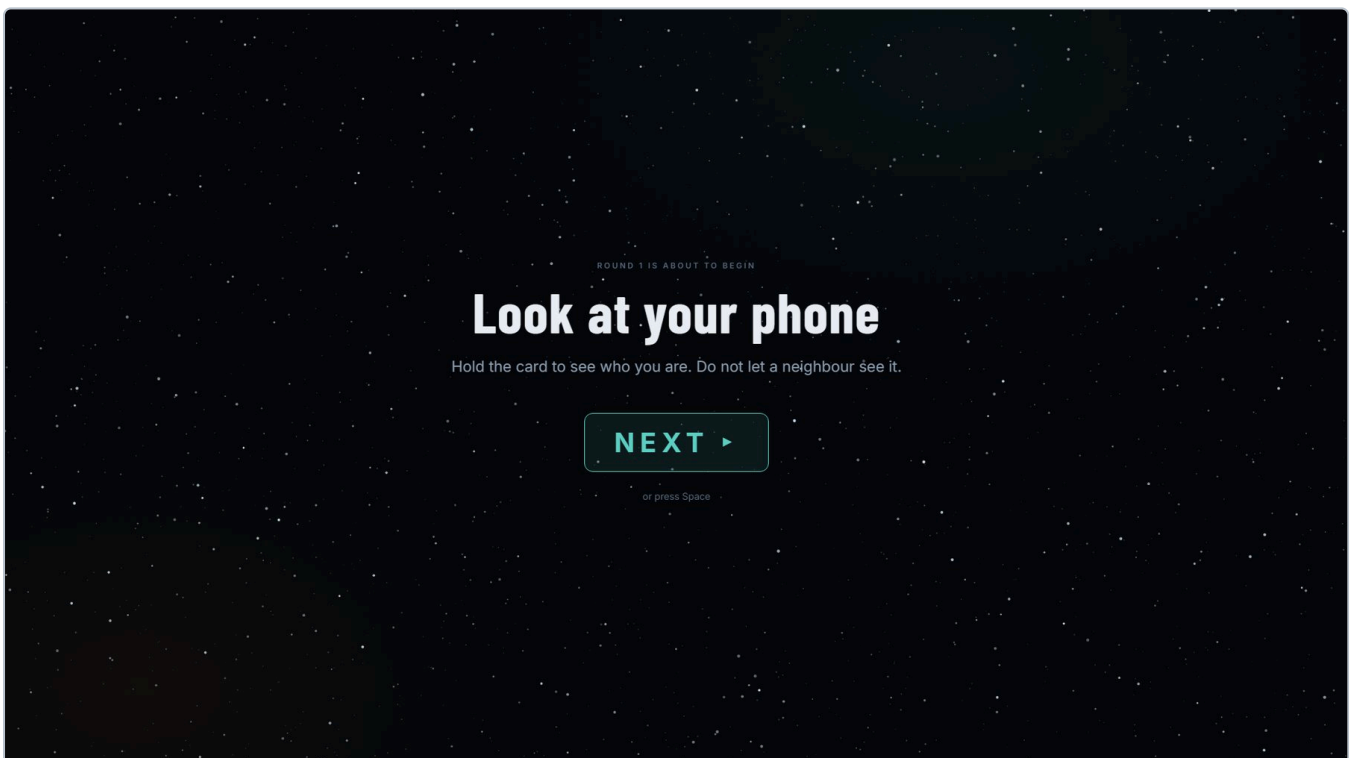
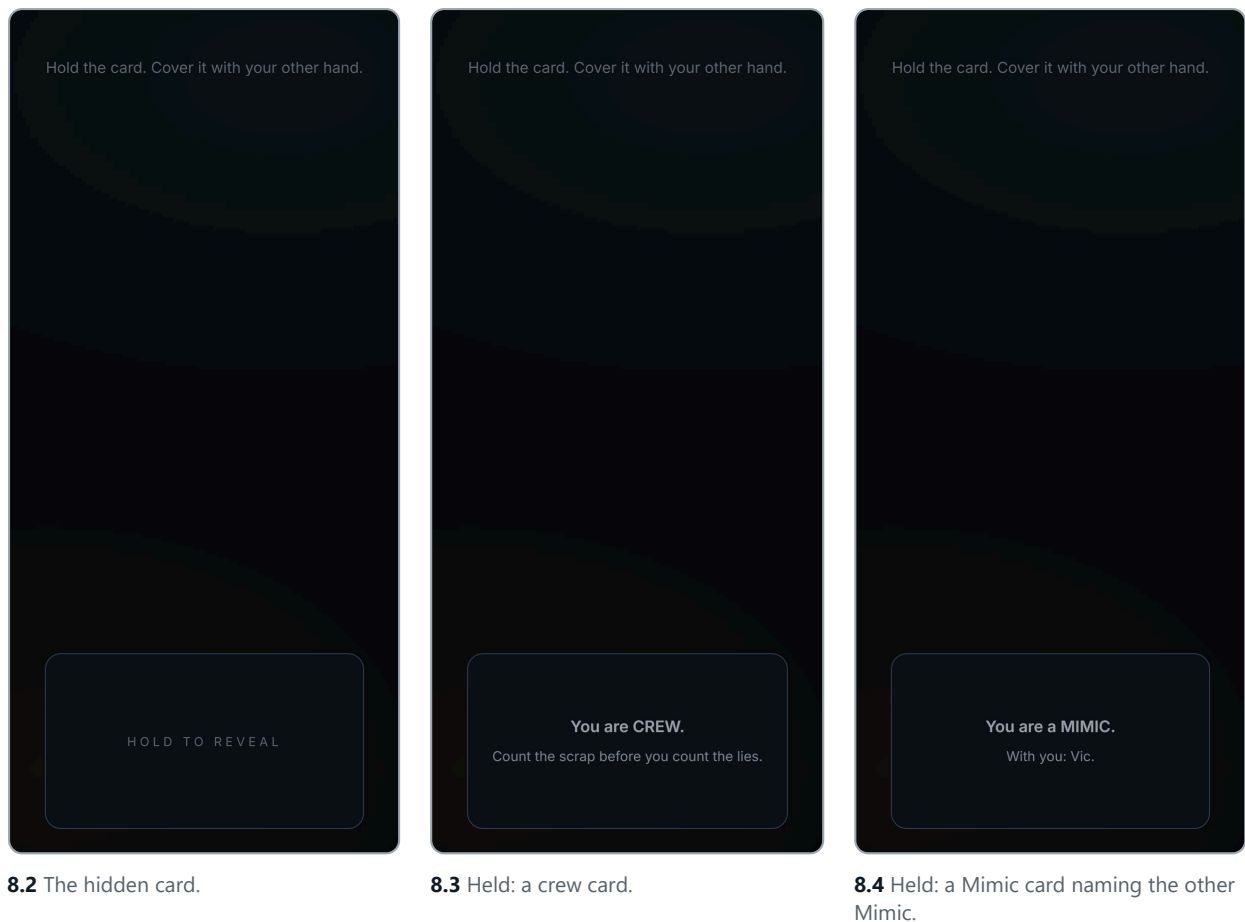


Figure 8.1 The monitor during the role reveal in a manual-steps game (a timed game shows a large countdown instead of **NEXT**).



9. The ship

The ship flies left to right: engines and the Reactor at the back (left), Steering with the viewport at the nose (right). It has five rooms. Players may stand in **any** room every round; there is no movement limit. **Pipes** connect some rooms. Pipes matter only for **sabotage range**.

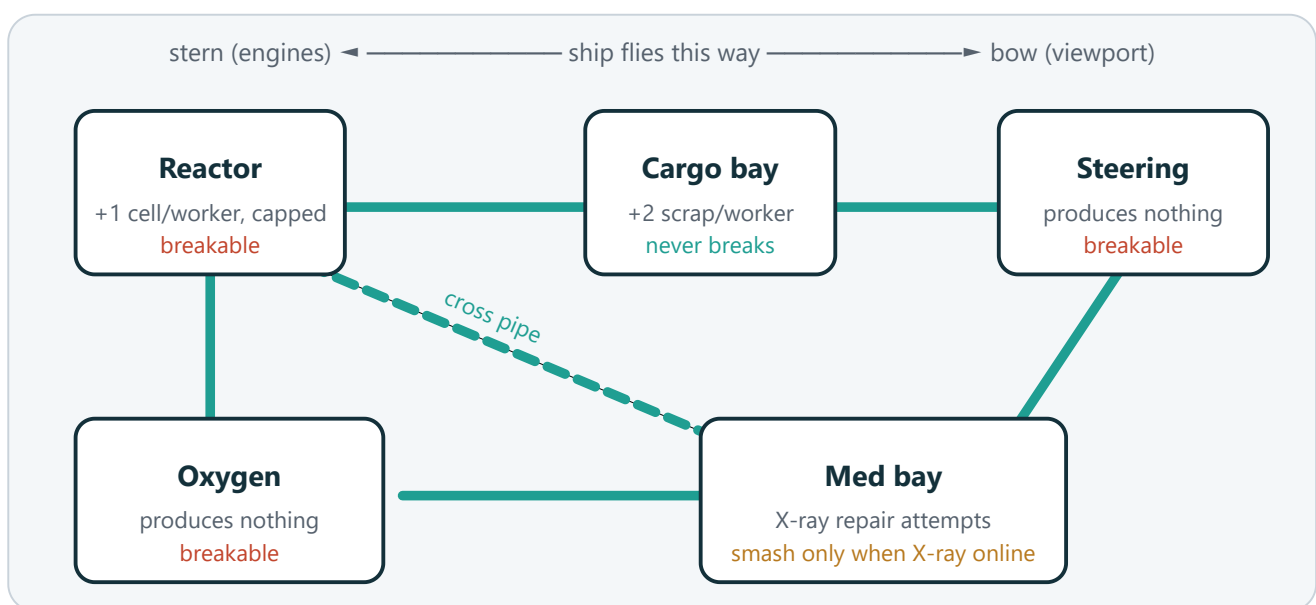


Figure 9.1 — The five rooms and the six pipes (teal lines). The dashed line is the diagonal cross pipe between the Reactor and the Med bay.

9.1 The rooms

Room	Working here does	Can it be broken?	Pipes to
Reactor	+1 power cell per worker, but never more than the Reactor cap (default 3, or 6 at 10–12 players) per round.	Yes. Only from a neighbouring room, never from inside.	Cargo bay, Oxygen, Med bay
Cargo bay	+2 scrap per worker. No cap.	Never.	Reactor, Steering
Steering	Nothing (except repairing it when broken).	Yes. From inside, or from a neighbour.	Cargo bay, Med bay
Oxygen	Nothing (except repairing it when broken).	Yes. From inside, or from a neighbour.	Med bay, Reactor
Med bay	One X-ray repair attempt per worker (costs scrap, may fail). Nothing once the X-ray is online.	Never broken. Once the X-ray is online it can be smashed from a neighbour (section 11.5).	Steering, Oxygen, Reactor

THE SIX PIPES

Reactor–Cargo bay · Cargo bay–Steering · Steering–Med bay · Med bay–Oxygen · Oxygen–Reactor · Reactor–Med bay (the diagonal cross pipe). There are no others. In particular, **Cargo bay and Med bay are not connected**, **Cargo bay and Oxygen are not connected**, and **Steering and Reactor are not connected**, and neither are Steering and Oxygen.

10. Resources and the X-ray

10.1 The shared pools

Resource	Start	Gained by	Spent on / lost by
Scrap	2	Working in the Cargo bay: +2 each.	X-ray repair attempts (1 each). Destroyed by a Mimic theft in the Cargo bay (2 per theft).
Power cells	0	Working in the Reactor: +1 each, capped per round.	Firing the X-ray (a scan costs 4 cells by default). Destroyed by a Mimic theft in the Reactor (2 per theft).

- Both pools belong to the whole ship, not to individuals. They are shown on the monitor at all times.
- Pools cannot go below 0 and have no maximum.
- Pools carry over between rounds.

10.2 The X-ray repair track

- The X-ray starts broken, with repair progress **0 of 6**.

- Each Med bay worker makes one **repair attempt** per round. An attempt costs 1 scrap. If the pool has no scrap left, the attempt does nothing and costs nothing.
- A paid attempt succeeds with a **60 %** chance and adds 1 repair point.
- When progress reaches **6**, the X-ray is **online**. Progress never goes above the target.
- Once online, Med bay workers make no attempts and spend no scrap. The Med bay reports **nothing to do**.
- The X-ray goes offline again only if a Mimic **smashes** it (section 11.5). That removes one repair point, so it needs one successful repair to come back online.

10.3 When can the crew scan?

A vote (and scan) happens at the end of a round only if **all three** are true after that round resolves:

1. the X-ray is online;
2. the pool has at least the scan cost in power cells (4 by default);
3. at least 2 players are alive.

If any condition fails, the round ends without a vote. The monitor says which condition was missing (section 19.1).

11. The round and your action

11.1 Phases of a round

#	Phase	Monitor title	Default time	What happens	Phones show
–	Roles	Look at your phone	30 s	Once, before round 1. Players read their role card.	Role card
1	Report	Ship report	20 s	A new round begins. Broken rooms' fuses tick down; a fuse at 0 ends the game. The monitor shows the state of the ship.	Look at the monitor.
2	Talk	Talk out loud	150 s	Discussion at the table: plans, accusations, alibis. No phone use. (Phones down. Work out who is lying.)	Look at the monitor.
3	Act	Choose your action	60 s	Every living player secretly picks a room, a focus and a button on their phone, then locks in. (Room, focus, button, lock in.)	The action flow
4	Resolve	What happened	30 s	The server resolves all actions at once. The monitor reveals where everyone stood and what each room produced.	Look at the monitor.

#	Phase	Monitor title	Default time	What happens	Phones show
5	Vote	Vote	60 s	Only if the scan conditions are met (10.3). Players vote on who to scan; the result is revealed.	The ballot

- The **Act** phase ends early, about 1 second after **every living player** has locked in.
- A **Vote** ballot closes early, about 1 second after **everyone allowed to vote** has voted. The result then stays on screen for 8 seconds before the game moves on.
- After the last round's Resolve (and its vote, if any) the game ends and the result is shown.
- In manual-steps games there are no countdowns: the host moves each phase on (section 26).

11.2 The action: room, focus, button

Every living player, whatever their role, submits exactly one action per round with the same three parts:

Part	Meaning
Room	Where you stand this round. Any of the five rooms. Your room becomes public when the round resolves.
Focus	The room you are paying attention to. You can choose your own room or any room connected to it by a pipe. For crew the focus changes nothing. For a Mimic pressing SABO , the focus picks the target (11.3).
Button	WORK or SABO . The two buttons look identical and swap sides at random.

THE MOST IMPORTANT RULE

A crew member always works, whatever focus and button they choose. A crew **SABO** is exactly the same as **WORK**. It leaves no trace in the state, the report or the log. Crew members are encouraged to press both buttons over the game, so pressing **SABO** is never suspicious in itself.

If a living player does not lock in before Act ends (phone off, timed out, never finished), they automatically **work in the room they stood in last round** (in round 1, the **Cargo bay**).

11.3 What a Mimic's SABO does — the focus rule

For a Mimic, **WORK** is ordinary work. **SABO** is turned into an effect by the server, using the Mimic's room and focus:

Mimic stands in	Focus	Result of SABO
Med bay	Med bay (own room)	CORRUPT : one of this round's Med bay repair attempts is ruined (11.6).
Cargo bay	Cargo bay (own room)	STEAL scrap : destroys 2 scrap (11.7).
Reactor	Reactor (own room)	STEAL cells : destroys 2 power cells (11.7).
Steering	Steering (own room)	BREAK Steering (11.4).

Mimic stands in	Focus	Result of SABO
Oxygen	Oxygen (own room)	BREAK Oxygen (11.4).
any room	a neighbour that can break and is not already broken	BREAK that room (11.4).
Reactor, Steering or Oxygen	Med bay, while the X-ray is online	SMASH the X-ray (11.5).
anything else		Nothing: the Mimic simply works in their room. Examples: focusing the Cargo bay from a neighbour, focusing a room that is already broken, focusing the Med bay while the X-ray is still offline.

An invalid **SABO** is **never refused** by the phone or the server, and nobody is told. It quietly becomes work. This is deliberate: if the app refused it, a Mimic's phone would behave differently from a crew phone.

11.4 The complete sabotage map

What a Mimic can do from each room with **SABO**. The focus screen offers exactly the room itself plus its pipe neighbours.

Standing in	Focus choices offered	Focus → effect
Reactor	Reactor, Cargo bay, Oxygen, Med bay	Reactor → steal 2 cells · Oxygen → break Oxygen · Med bay → smash X-ray (only if online) · Cargo bay → nothing
Cargo bay	Cargo bay, Reactor, Steering	Cargo bay → steal 2 scrap · Reactor → break Reactor · Steering → break Steering
Steering	Steering, Cargo bay, Med bay	Steering → break Steering · Med bay → smash X-ray (only if online) · Cargo bay → nothing
Oxygen	Oxygen, Med bay, Reactor	Oxygen → break Oxygen · Reactor → break Reactor · Med bay → smash X-ray (only if online)
Med bay	Med bay, Steering, Oxygen, Reactor	Med bay → corrupt a repair · Steering → break Steering · Oxygen → break Oxygen · Reactor → break Reactor

The same information turned around, which is what the crew needs for deduction:

Event in the report	A Mimic must have stood in...
Reactor broken	Cargo bay, Oxygen or Med bay (never the Reactor itself)
Steering broken	Steering, Cargo bay or Med bay
Oxygen broken	Oxygen, Reactor or Med bay
X-ray smashed	Reactor, Steering or Oxygen (never the Med bay itself)
Scrap stolen	Cargo bay

Event in the report	A Mimic must have stood in...
Power cells stolen	Reactor
A repair attempt corrupted	Med bay

11.5 Breaking a room, and smashing the X-ray

Breaking. Only the Reactor, Steering and Oxygen can be broken. A break needs the target to be **not already broken**. The room becomes broken with a **fuse of 3** (the Fuse length setting). A broken room shows a yellow and black hazard border and a **FUSE N** badge on the monitor.

- Breaking the Reactor stops its production: while it is broken, its first worker spends the round repairing (see 12.4). Its animated core goes dark on the monitor.
- Steering and Oxygen produce nothing anyway. Breaking them is purely a threat: an unrepaired fuse ends the game.
- A broken room is repaired by **anyone who works there** (section 12, step 4). It does not matter who; crew and Mimics who work both count.

Smashing the X-ray. Once the X-ray is online, a Mimic standing in the **Reactor, Steering or Oxygen** can focus the Med bay and press **SABO** :

- The repair track loses 1 point and the X-ray goes **offline**.
- The Med bay is **not** marked broken, has no fuse and cannot cause a hull breach.
- No vote can happen until the crew wins that point back with a successful repair attempt.
- The smash happens **before** this round's Med bay work. Crew already standing in the Med bay that round make paid repair attempts and can bring the X-ray straight back online in the same round. The report then reads **smashed, -1 repair · +1 repair**.
- A Mimic inside the Med bay pressing **SABO** on the Med bay is a **corrupt**, never a smash.



Figure 11.1 A smash that the crew undid in the same round: `smashed, -1 repair · +1 repair`. Rita was working in the Med bay, so her paid attempt won the point back and the X-ray is still `ONLINE`. The smash came from the Reactor or Oxygen (Steering was empty), so Maya, Nora, Omar, Tara and Vic are the suspects. Infection still rose by 2.

11.6 Corrupting a repair

- A Mimic in the Med bay who focuses the Med bay and presses `SAB0` corrupts **one** repair attempt this round.
- The ruined attempt still **costs its scrap**, but it **fails for certain**.
- The corrupting Mimic does not make a repair attempt themselves.
- It only has an effect if some other Med bay worker makes a **paid** attempt that round. With no other workers, no scrap, or with the X-ray already online, the corrupt does nothing at all.
- Two corrupts in the same round (possible in `Each` mode) ruin up to two attempts.

11.7 Stealing

- A Mimic in the **Cargo bay** focusing the Cargo bay destroys **2 scrap**. A Mimic in the **Reactor** focusing the Reactor destroys **2 power cells**.
- The theft happens **before** this round's production, so it takes from what was in the pool at the start of the round. The pool never goes below 0.
- The stealing Mimic produces nothing that round.
- A theft from an empty pool does nothing.
- Nothing on the monitor says "stolen". The crew has to notice that the pool is lower than it should be (section 34).

12. How a round resolves (exact order)

When Act ends, the server resolves the round in exactly this order. Every step happens in the same instant from the players' point of view, but the order decides many edge cases.

12.1 Step 1 — Fill in missing actions

Any living player who did not lock in works in their previous room (in round 1, the Cargo bay).

12.2 Step 2 — Work out each action, then choose which sabotages land

Each action becomes **work** or a sabotage (break, smash, corrupt or steal) by the rules in 11.3. Crew are always work. Then all positions become public.

Sabotages setting	What lands
Each (default)	Every Mimic's valid sabotage lands. Two breaks on two rooms break both; two corrupts ruin two attempts. If two Mimics aim at the same room, it breaks once and the second has no extra effect.
Team	At most one sabotage lands per round for the whole Mimic team. If several Mimics sabotage, one is picked at random. The others silently become work in the rooms those Mimics chose (so they produce, and they can repair). Nobody is told which was picked.

12.3 Step 3 — Apply the sabotages

Breaks set the room broken with a full fuse. A smash removes 1 repair point and takes the X-ray offline (only if it is still online at this moment). Thefts remove resources. Corrupts are counted for step 6.

12.4 Step 4 — Repair broken rooms

Every broken room that has **at least one worker** is repaired: it is no longer broken and its fuse is cleared. **One** of its workers, chosen at random, spends the round on the repair and produces nothing. **All other workers in that room produce normally.**

- A room broken in **this same round** is also repaired if anyone works in it. The break still counts for Infection (step 7).
- A Mimic who sabotages does not count as a worker, so a Mimic breaking the Steering while standing in it does not repair it.
- A break always costs the crew exactly one worker's action, never more.

12.5 Step 5 — Produce resources

- Cargo bay: +2 scrap for every remaining worker.
- Reactor: +1 cell for every remaining worker, then capped at the Reactor cap for the round. Example: 5 workers with a cap of 3 give 3 cells. A Reactor repaired this round with 3 workers gives 2 cells (one worker repaired).

12.6 Step 6 — The Med bay

- If the X-ray is online at this point, nothing happens in the Med bay and no scrap is spent.

- Otherwise, the number of attempts is the number of Med bay workers (capped by `Med bay seats`, unlimited by default).
- For each attempt: if scrap is below the repair cost, it does nothing. Otherwise it spends the scrap; if a corrupt is waiting, the corrupt is used up and the attempt fails; otherwise it succeeds with the repair chance (60 %).
- Successful attempts add repair points up to the target. Reaching the target brings the X-ray online.
- Because production (step 5) happens first, **scrap made in the Cargo bay this round can already pay for this round's repairs.**

12.7 Step 7 — Infection

If at least one **effective** sabotage happened, Infection rises by **2**. Otherwise it falls by **1**. It always stays between 0 and 12. See section 14 for exactly what counts.

12.8 Step 8 — The public report

The monitor shows, for each room: who stood there, and a short summary of what happened. It never shows who worked or who sabotaged, individual dice rolls, or which sabotage was chosen. Then the vote runs if the scan conditions are met (section 15), and after the last round the game ends (section 17).

12.9 Room summaries in the report

Summary text	Meaning
<code>repaired</code>	This room was broken (before or during this round) and a worker repaired it.
<code>+N power cell(s)</code>	Reactor output this round (after the cap).
<code>+N scrap</code>	Cargo bay output this round.
<code>+N repair</code>	Med bay: N successful repair points this round.
<code>no repair</code>	Med bay: people worked there, but no point was gained (all attempts failed, were corrupted, or could not be paid for).
<code>smashed, -1 repair</code>	Med bay: the X-ray was smashed this round.
<code>broken, fuse N</code>	The room is still broken after this round, with N rounds on its fuse. (In the ship log. On the map the live fuse badge shows this instead.)
<code>nothing to do</code>	People stood here but nothing came of it: Steering or Oxygen when not broken, a Med bay while the X-ray is online, or a Reactor/Cargo bay where nobody's work counted (for example everyone there sabotaged).
<code>empty</code>	Nobody stood here.

Several parts are joined with `·`, for example `repaired · +2 power cells` or `smashed, -1 repair · +1 repair`.

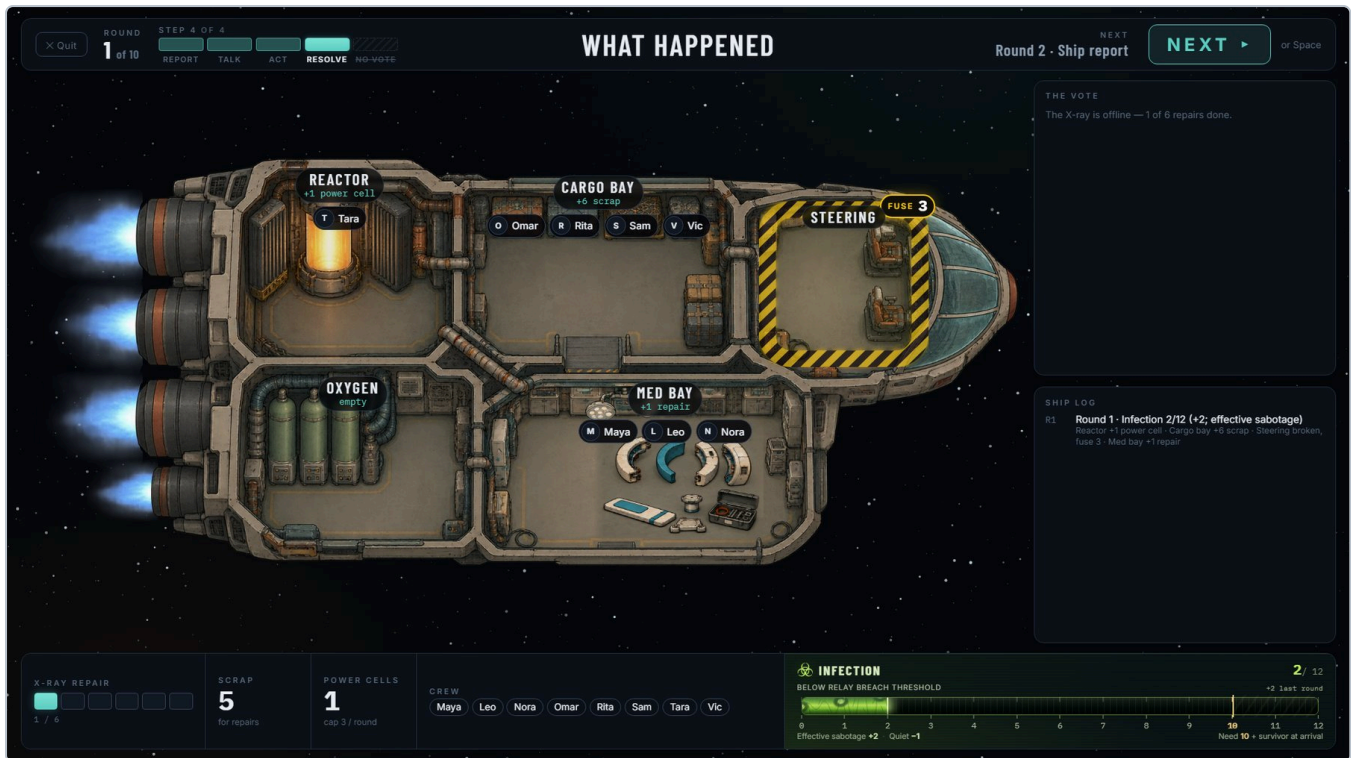


Figure 12.1 Round 1 resolved. Tara worked the Reactor (+1 power cell). Four people stood in the Cargo bay but it made +6 scrap, not +8: one of them sabotaged. Steering is broken with **FUSE 3**, and it could only have been broken from Steering, the Cargo bay or the Med bay. Three Med bay attempts gave +1 repair. Infection went from 0 to 2.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Start of round: scrap 5, cells 1, repair 1/6, nothing broken, Infection 2. Actions: Leo, Nora and Maya in the Med bay; Omar, Sam and Rita (a Mimic) in the Cargo bay, Rita focusing the Cargo bay with SABO; Tara in the Reactor; Vic (a Mimic) in Oxygen focusing the Reactor with SABO.

1. Rita steals 2 scrap: 5 → 3. Vic breaks the Reactor (fuse 3).
2. The Reactor has a worker (Tara), so it is repaired. Tara spends the round repairing: +0 cells.
3. Cargo bay: Omar and Sam produce +4 scrap: 3 → 7.
4. Med bay: 3 paid attempts (7 → 4 scrap). Say two succeed: repair 1 → 3.
5. Effective sabotage happened (a new break, and a theft that removed scrap): Infection 2 → 4.

Report: Reactor repaired (Tara) · Cargo bay +4 scrap (Omar, Rita, Sam) · Med bay +2 repair · Oxygen nothing to do (Vic) · Steering empty. The crew sees the Reactor was broken, which means someone in the Cargo bay, Oxygen or Med bay did it, and that three people in the Cargo bay made only +4.

13. Fuses and the hull breach

- A room broken in round **N** gets a fuse of **3** immediately.
- At the start of every later round (the Report phase), every broken room's fuse goes down by 1.
- If any fuse reaches **0**, the Mimics win immediately: **HULL_BREACH**. The log reads **The Steering fuse burned out. Hull breach.** (with that room's name).

- So a room broken in round N must be repaired during round **N, N+1 or N+2**. If it is still broken when round N+3 begins, the ship is lost.
- With a custom Fuse length L, the deadline is round N+L-1, and the breach happens as round N+L begins.
- The fuse badge on the map turns **red** when 1 round is left.
- Repairing a room clears its fuse completely. If it is broken again later, it starts again from the full fuse.
- Fuses are only checked at the start of a round. A room broken during the **final** round cannot cause a breach, because no later round begins. The game ends on the Infection check instead.

Broken during round	Fuse shown after Resolve	Report of round N+1	Report of N+2	Start of N+3
N (fuse length 3)	3	2	1 (red)	0 → hull breach



Figure 13.1 The report at the start of round 2. The Steering fuse has ticked from 3 to 2. The report text under each room still shows the previous round's results until the new round resolves.

14. Infection

Infection is the Mimic team's progress meter, from **0 to 12**. The Mimics need it at **10 or more** when the ship arrives (and a Mimic alive). Everyone sees it on the monitor.

14.1 How it changes

- It starts at **0**.
- It changes **once per round**, when the round resolves (section 12, step 7).
- **+2** if at least one effective sabotage happened this round. This is +2 for the whole team, **not per sabotage**, even in **Each** mode with several sabotages.
- **-1** if no effective sabotage happened (a "quiet" round).
- It never goes below 0 or above 12.

- Reaching 10 or 12 early does **not** end the game. Only the value at arrival matters.
- The last round's change happens **before** that round's vote and before the arrival check.

14.2 What counts as effective sabotage

Counts (+2)	Does not count
A new break of the Reactor, Steering or Oxygen — even if it is repaired in the same round.	A break aimed at a room that is already broken (it resolves as work).
A smash of the online X-ray — even if the crew wins the point back in the same round.	A smash attempt while the X-ray is offline (resolves as work).
A theft that actually removes at least one scrap or cell.	A theft from an empty pool.
A corrupt that ruins a paid crew repair attempt — even if that attempt would have failed anyway.	A corrupt when no other attempt was paid for (no other Med bay workers, no scrap, or X-ray online).
	Any invalid SABO (it becomes work). A room that is <i>still</i> broken from an earlier round. A crew SABO. In Team mode, sabotages that were not picked.

THE METER REVEALS INFORMATION

Because the meter goes up by 2 or down by 1, **everyone can see whether effective sabotage happened each round**, including a corrupt that is otherwise invisible. The log records it as (+2; effective sabotage) or (-1; no effective sabotage). It never says who.

14.3 What the numbers mean in practice

- From 0, the Mimics need **at least five** rounds of effective sabotage to reach 10 ($5 \times 2 = 10$), more if there are quiet rounds in between.
- In a 10-round game, if the Mimics wait until round 7 to start, they can reach at most $4 \text{ rounds} \times 2 = 8$ minus earlier decay. That is too late.
- At 10 before a quiet final round: $10 - 1 = 9$ at arrival, and the Mimics lose.
- At 12, the Mimics can afford two quiet rounds ($12 \rightarrow 11 \rightarrow 10$) and still win at arrival.
- Every quiet round costs 1 and every active round gains 2, so the Mimics need roughly two active rounds for every quiet one just to make progress.



Figure 14.1 The Infection meter: level 2 / 12, the 0–12 scale with the threshold at 10, the last change (+2 last round) and the reminder Effective sabotage +2 · Quiet -1 / Need 10 + survivor at arrival.

15. Voting and scanning

15.1 When a vote happens

Right after a round's Resolve phase, if the X-ray is online, the pool holds at least the scan cost in power cells, and at least 2 players are alive (section 10.3). Otherwise the round simply ends, and the round-steps bar shows **No vote** . Whether there will be a vote cannot be known before Resolve, because a theft or a smash during the round can change it.

15.2 The first ballot

- Every **living** player votes.
- The choices are every **living, unverified** player, plus **SKIP** . Verified crew are never on the ballot. Eliminated players cannot vote and are not on it.
- **Voting for yourself** is allowed on the first ballot (unless the host switched off **Allow self-vote** ; then your own tile is disabled).
- **SKIP** means “do not scan anyone”. Each player may use SKIP on only **one ballot per game**. It is used up when that ballot closes. After that, your SKIP tile reads **SKIP USED** and is disabled, and on every later first ballot you must name a player (or not vote).
- Voting takes two taps: pick a name (or SKIP), then **LOCK IN** . Before locking in you can go **BACK** and choose again. **After locking in, the phone does not let you change your vote.**
- A player who has not voted when the time runs out simply casts no ballot.
- Ballots are secret while the vote is open. The monitor only shows who has voted.



15.1 A later first ballot in the example game. Leo (an eliminated Mimic) and Nora (verified crew) are no longer choices. The remaining living players and SKIP are.

15.3 Counting the first ballot

Find the highest number of votes, and every choice that has it.

Top of the count	Result
Nobody voted at all	Treated as a skip. No scan, no cells spent.

Top of the count	Result
SKIP is among the top (alone or tied)	No scan. No cells spent. No scan. The cells stay in the pool.
Exactly one player is on top	That player is scanned .
Two or more players tied on top (and SKIP is not)	A runoff between the tied players.

EXAMPLES

Omar 3, Rita 2, SKIP 1 → Omar is scanned. · Omar 3, SKIP 3 → no scan. · Omar 3, Rita 3, SKIP 1 → runoff between Omar and Rita. · Omar 2, Rita 2, Leo 2 → runoff between all three.

15.4 The runoff

- Only the tied players are on the runoff ballot.
- The tied players do not vote.** Everyone else who is alive decides. The candidates' phones say **You are on the ballot.** / **The rest of the crew decides. Talk, do not vote.**
- SKIP is **not** available in a runoff, and self-voting does not arise.
- If exactly one candidate gets the most votes, they are scanned.
- If the runoff is tied again, or nobody voted, or nobody was left to vote: **no scan**, no cells spent (**Tied again. No scan, nothing spent.**).
- There is never a second runoff.



Figure 15.2 A first ballot ending in a tie: three votes each for Nora and Omar (and one for Vic), so the result is **Tied – runoff between Nora and Omar.**

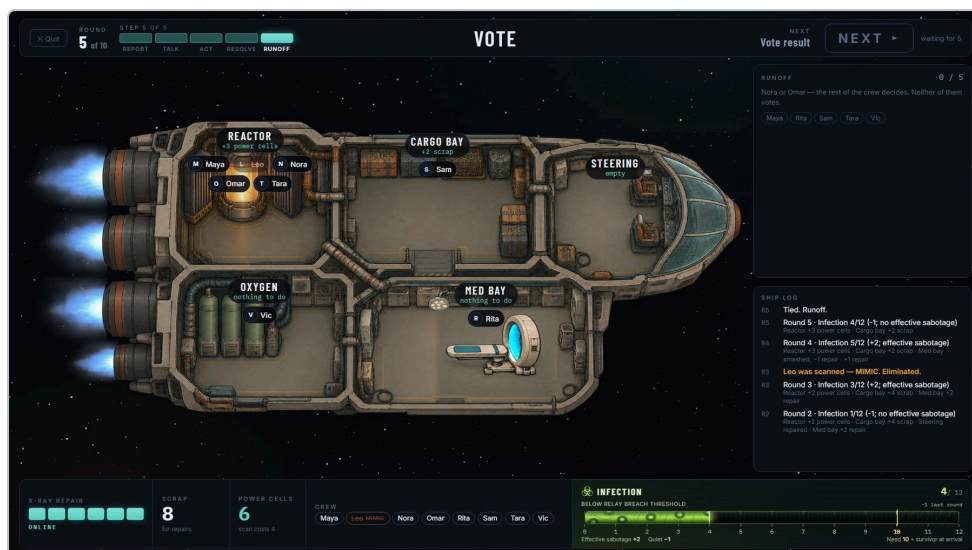
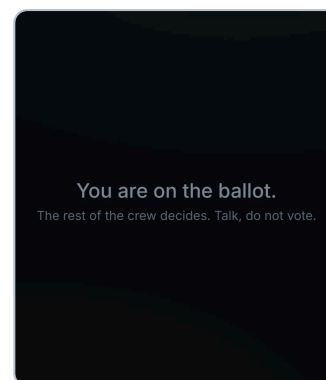


Figure 15.3 The runoff ballot. Only the five other living players vote; the step track reads **RUNOFF**.



15.4 A candidate's phone.

15.5 The scan

- The scan spends the scan cost in power cells (4 by default).
- The monitor reveals the result: **Name is a MIMIC. Eliminated.** or **Name is CREW. Verified.**
- **Mimic:** eliminated, role public. If that was the last living Mimic, the crew wins immediately.
- **Crew:** verified for the rest of the game and removed from all later ballots.
- Only one scan can happen per round.
- When the scan finds the **last** Mimic, the game ends at that instant and the monitor goes straight to the game-over screen.

15.6 Who voted for whom

Normally, once a ballot closes, **every ballot is shown on the monitor with voter names**, grouped by choice, in the vote panel. This is part of the deduction: who pushed a scan onto a crew member, who protected a caught Mimic. The ballots stay on screen while the result is shown (8 seconds in a timed game, or until the host presses Next) and disappear when the next round begins. The ship log keeps only the outcome, so **note who voted for whom while it is on screen**. With **Votes hidden** on, only the outcome is ever shown (section 27).



Figure 15.5 A vote result. Six players voted for Rita, Vic used his SKIP, and Rita voted for Maya. Rita is scanned and revealed as a Mimic; her chip is struck through and her crew pill is tagged **MIMIC**. The scan cost 4 cells (6 → 2). Notice who did *not* vote for Rita: that is information for later.

16. Elimination and the spectator view

- Only scanned Mimics are eliminated. They stay at the table.
- Their phone switches to the **spectator view**: **Eliminated** · **spectator**, every player's **true role** and room, and under **Last round** exactly what every player did in the most recent round (for example **BREAK Reactor**, **STEAL scrap**, **CORRUPT**, **WORK**).
- At the bottom: **Stay silent. Let them work it out.** An eliminated player must not reveal anything. The app cannot enforce this; it is table etiquette.
- Eliminated players cannot act or vote. On the map their chip is dimmed and struck through, and their crew pill shows the **MIMIC** tag.
- The eliminated player still wins if the Mimic team wins.



16.1 The spectator view of an eliminated Mimic: true roles and last round's actions for everyone.

17. How the game ends

17.1 The four endings, in the order they are checked

#	Ending	When it is checked	Winner	Game-over text
1	Hull breach	At the start of every round, after fuses tick.	Mimics	The Mimics win — A fuse burned out. The ship is gone.
2	All Mimics found	Immediately after a scan (and at the end of a round).	Crew	The crew survives — Every Mimic was found and scanned.
3	Reached the relay	After the final round completes, including its Infection change and its vote.	Mimics	The Mimics win — Infection overwhelmed the relay defences. A Mimic survived to reach the station.
4	Infection contained	Same moment as 3, when Infection is below 10.	Crew	The crew survives — Infection stayed below the breach threshold. Relay screening destroyed the remaining Mimics.

- A scan in the final round that finds the last Mimic wins for the crew, whatever the Infection level.
- There are no draws. If the host quits, the game simply ends with no winner (section 22).

17.2 Timeline of a whole game

Lobby → Roles (30 s)

Round 1: Report → Talk → Act → Resolve → [Vote if possible]

Round 2: Report (fuses tick, breach check) → Talk → Act → Resolve → [Vote]

...

Round 10: Report → Talk → Act → Resolve (Infection settles) → [Vote] → arrival check → Game over

Part III · The screens

Every element of the monitor and the phone, and what it means

The monitor is the table's shared source of truth. The phone is only for secret choices. This part walks through both, screen by screen.

18. The monitor during a round

From the first round to the end of the game, the monitor keeps one fixed layout with no scrolling: a **header bar** at the top, the **ship map** in the middle, a **right rail** with the vote panel and the log, and a **status strip** at the bottom.



Figure 18.1 The monitor at the start of round 1 (Ship report): header, map, the vote panel and ship log on the right, and the status strip with the Infection meter at the bottom.

18.1 The header bar



Figure 18.2 The header in a manual-steps game.

Element	Meaning
✕ Quit	Host only. Ends the game for everyone after a confirmation (section 22).
ROUND 4 of 10	The current round and the total.
Step track: STEP 3 OF 5	Five segments: REPORT, TALK, ACT, RESOLVE, VOTE. Finished steps are filled, the current step is highlighted. The vote segment is dashed while nobody can know yet whether a vote will happen. Once the round resolves, it either stays (a vote is coming) or reads NO VOTE struck through, and the count becomes of 4. During a runoff it reads RUNOFF.
Phase title	SHIP REPORT, TALK OUT LOUD (with Phones down. Work out who is lying.), CHOOSE YOUR ACTION (with Room, focus, button, lock in.), WHAT HAPPENED, VOTE.
NEXT + label	What comes after this step: Round 2 · Ship report, Talk out loud, Choose your action, What happened, Vote, Vote result, Runoff vote or Game over.
Countdown (timed games)	Large m:ss clock for the current phase. It turns amber in the last 10 seconds. All screens count down from the server's clock.
NEXT ► (manual steps)	Host only: moves to the next step. Beside it: or Space when it can be pressed, waiting for N while Act or a ballot is still waiting for N players, or ... for a brief settling pause. A non-host screen shows The host moves on.



Figure 18.3 The header in a timed game: the countdown sits where the **NEXT** button would be.

18.2 The ship map

Element	Meaning
Room name plates	Each room's name, and under it the room's summary from the last resolved round (section 12.9). Summaries are hidden during Act.
Player chips	A chip with initials and name for every player in the room where they stood last round . Chips stay in place until the next Resolve. A verified player's chip has a green border. An eliminated player's chip is dimmed and struck through, in the room they last stood in. Before round 1 resolves, no chips are shown.
Hazard border + FUSE N	The room is broken. N is the number of rounds on its fuse. The badge turns red at 1 (section 13).
Reactor core	The glowing core animates while the Reactor works. It goes dark and still while the Reactor is broken.
X-ray machine (Med bay)	The scanner is drawn in pieces that assemble as repair progress rises, and complete at the target. When it is online and the pool has enough cells for a scan, it glows with a pulsing ring: a scan is possible this round.
LOCKED IN 3 / 8	During Act only: how many living players have locked in. It updates only every 5 seconds, so nobody can match the count to a neighbour lowering their phone. All chips and summaries are hidden during Act.
Engine flames, starfield	Decoration. The stars drift to show the ship flying left to right. Animations stop if the device asks for reduced motion.



Figure 18.4 During Act the map hides everything about positions. Only **LOCKED IN 1 / 8** is shown.

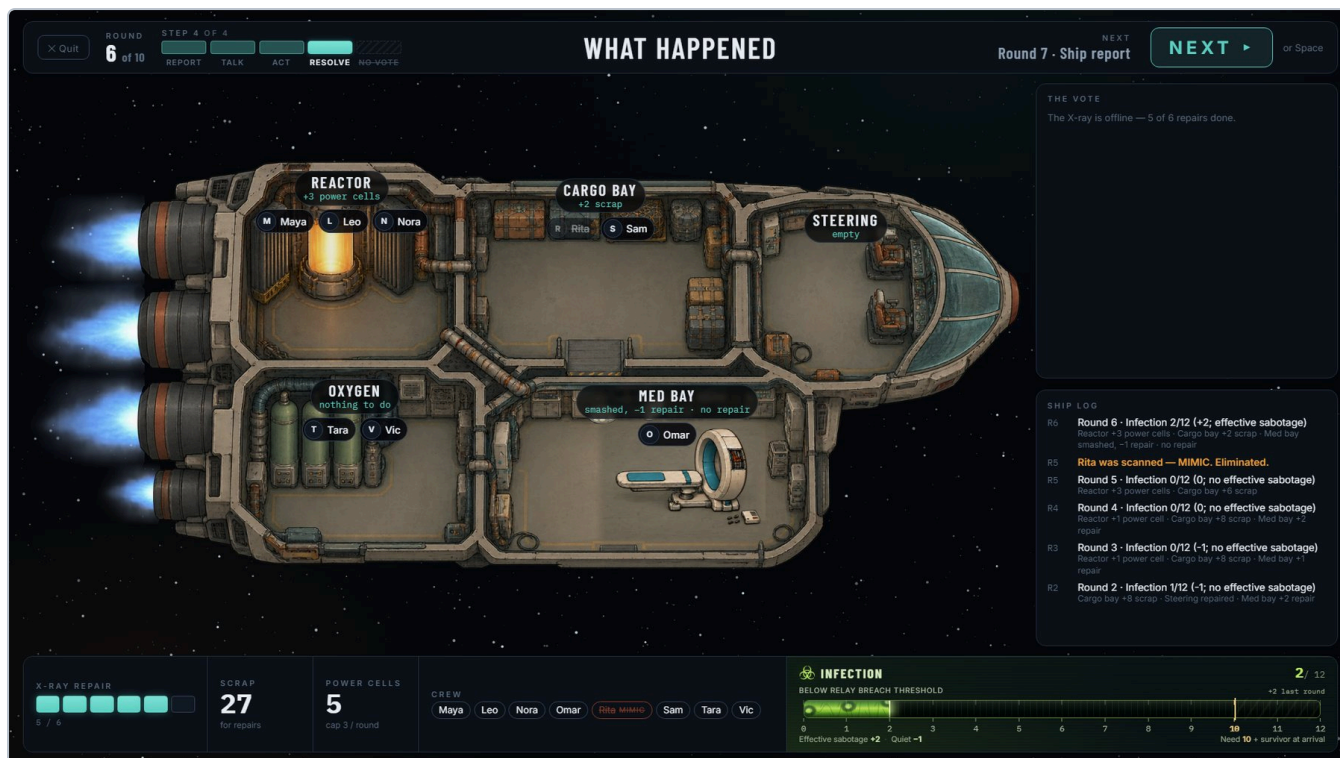


Figure 18.5 A round with a smash. The X-ray was online; now the repair track shows 5 of 6 and the Med bay reads **smashed**, **-1 repair** · **no repair**: Omar's repair attempt failed. The smash could only have come from the Reactor, Steering or Oxygen, so Maya, Leo, Nora, Tara and Vic are the suspects. Infection rose by 2. Rita, eliminated last round, is struck through in the Cargo bay and tagged **MIMIC** in the crew list.

18.3 The status strip

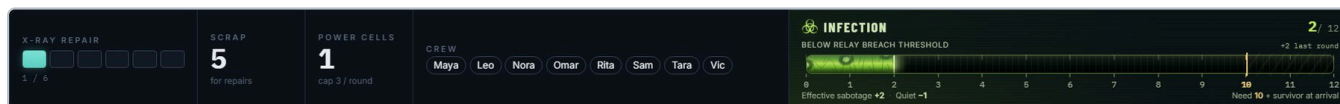


Figure 18.6 The status strip.

Block	Meaning
X-RAY REPAIR	One segment per repair point needed (6 by default), filled as progress rises. Underneath: 3 / 6 , or ONLINE once complete.
SCRAP	Scrap in the pool, for repairs .
POWER CELLS	Cells in the pool. Underneath: cap 3 / round while the X-ray is offline, scan costs 4 once it is online. The block is highlighted when a scan is affordable.
CREW	Every player in seating order. ✓ and a green border = verified crew. Red with MIMIC and struck through = eliminated Mimic. Faded = that phone is disconnected.
INFECTION	The Infection meter (section 14): the level out of 12, a tube filling from 0 to 12 with a marker at 10, BELOW RELAY BREACH THRESHOLD or RELAY DEFENCES COMPROMISED (at 10+), the last change (+2 last round , -1 last round , 0 last round , or Awaiting first round), and the rule reminders.

19. The right rail: vote panel and log

19.1 The vote panel

Situation	What the panel shows
No vote running, X-ray offline	The X-ray is offline – 3 of 6 repairs done.
X-ray online, too few cells	A scan costs 4 power cells and the pool holds 2.
Fewer than 2 players alive	Not enough of the crew left to hold a vote.
All conditions met	The X-ray is charged. The crew votes at the end of this round. (Theft or a smash during the round can still prevent it.)
First ballot open	Ballots are secret until the vote closes. Decide out loud. (or, with hidden votes, Ballots are secret and stay secret. Only the result is shown.), a counter 3 / 8 , and a pill for each voter that lights up once they have voted.
Runoff open	Omar or Sam – the rest of the crew decides. Neither of them votes. and pills for the voters only.
Result	A row per choice with the number of votes and the voters' names (not with hidden votes: Votes are hidden in this game.), the scanned player's row outlined, and the outcome: Rita is a MIMIC. Eliminated. (red), Omar is CREW. Verified., No scan. The cells stay in the pool., Tied – runoff between Omar and Sam. or Tied again. No scan, nothing spent.

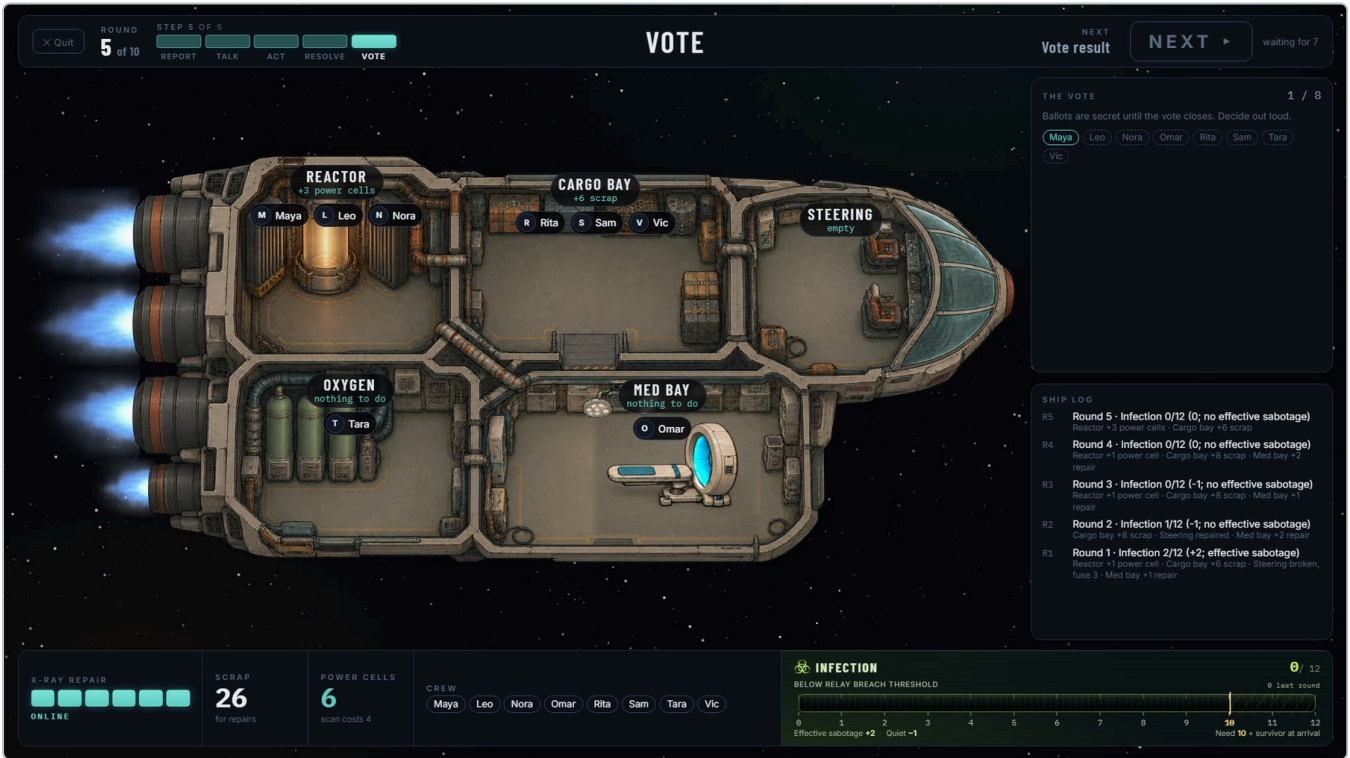


Figure 19.1 A ballot in progress in a manual-steps game: 1 / 8 voted (Maya's pill is lit), the ballots themselves are secret, and the host's NEXT reads waiting for 7. The X-ray in the Med bay glows because a scan is affordable.

19.2 The ship log

- Shows the most recent entries (about the last three rounds), newest at the top. Before anything happens: `Nothing has happened yet.`
- A round line: `Round 1 · Infection 2/12 (+2; effective sabotage)`, with the room summaries underneath (empty rooms and `nothing to do` are left out; a round with nothing else reads `a quiet round`). A change of `0` means the level could not move: it was already at 0 in a quiet round, or already at 12 in an active one.
- Scan lines, highlighted: `Rita was scanned – MIMIC. Eliminated. / Omar was scanned – CREW. Verified.`
- Vote lines: `The crew skipped the scan., Tied. Runoff., Runoff tied. No scan.`
- End lines: the hull breach or arrival message.
- The full log, from the first round, is shown on the game-over screen.

19.3 The crew chat tab (games with bots)

When at least one bot is seated, the log panel has two tabs: `Ship log` and `Crew chat` (with a message count). The chat shows what the bots say, with a round divider and a colour per speaker. It is read-only; there is no way for humans to type.

- The tab follows the game on its own: chat during Talk, Act and Vote (once a bot has said something), the ship log during Report and Resolve.
- Clicking a tab pins it until the next phase starts.
- Before any bot speaks: `The bots have nothing to say yet.`



Figure 19.2 A timed game with bots during Talk: the `Crew chat` tab is showing the bots' discussion.

20. The phone, screen by screen

The phone deliberately shows as little as possible. Its screens are grey on black, easy to read at arm's length and hard to read from the next seat. Everything you tap sits in the lower half of the screen so you can hold the phone low. Use it upright; in landscape it says `Turn your phone upright.`

20.1 Every phone screen

When	The phone shows
Lobby	<code>You're in.</code> / <code>Look at the monitor.</code> and your name and the room code.
Role reveal	<code>Hold the card.</code> <code>Cover it with your other hand.</code> and the card (section 8.3).
Report, Talk, Resolve	<code>Look at the monitor.</code>
Act, not locked in	The action flow: <code>WHERE DO YOU STAND?</code> → <code>FOCUS</code> → <code>ACTION</code> → <code>READY</code> .
Act, locked in	<code>Locked in.</code> / <code>Look at the monitor.</code> and a <code>CHANGE</code> button.
Vote, may vote	The ballot: <code>WHO GETS SCANNED?</code> (or <code>RUNOFF</code>) → <code>READY</code> .
Vote, voted	<code>Locked in.</code> / <code>Look at the monitor.</code>
Runoff candidate	<code>You are on the ballot.</code> / <code>The rest of the crew decides.</code> <code>Talk,</code> <code>do not vote.</code>
Vote closed	<code>Votes are in.</code> / <code>Look at the monitor.</code> (if you did not vote) or <code>Locked in.</code>
Eliminated	The spectator view (section 16), for the rest of the game.
Game over	<code>Game over.</code> / <code>Look at the monitor.</code> and <code>MAIN MENU</code> .
Connection lost	<code>Reconnecting...</code> until the connection is back.

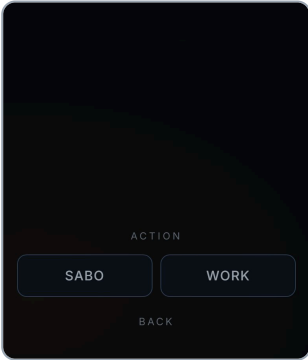
20.2 The action flow (four taps)



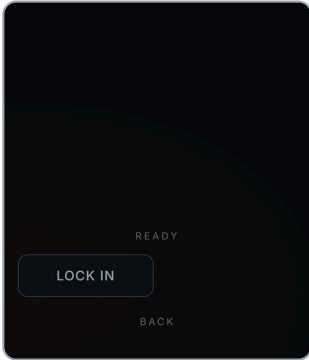
1. Room. The five rooms, always in the same order. A broken room carries a `BROKEN` mark.



2. Focus. Your room and its pipe neighbours, in a shuffled order.



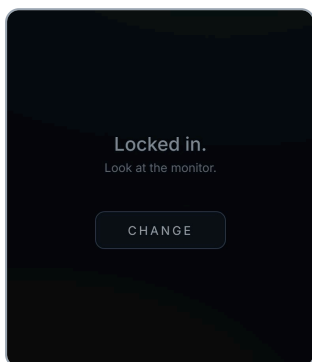
3. Action. `WORK` and `SABO`, side by side in random order.



4. Ready. `LOCK IN` sends the choice.

- **BACK** under steps 2–4 goes back one step. Nothing is sent until `LOCK IN` .

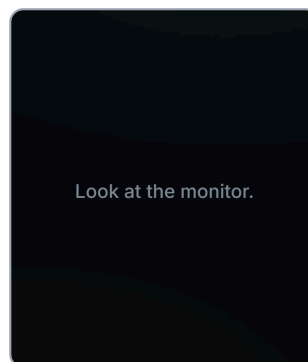
- Every screen fades in, and taps are ignored for 0.7 seconds after a screen appears. This stops accidental double taps and makes every player's tapping rhythm look the same.
- The order of the focus tiles and of the two buttons is shuffled **for each player, each round**. Watching where someone taps tells you nothing.
- After **LOCK IN**, the phone shows **Locked in.** with **CHANGE**. Pressing **CHANGE** restarts the flow; your new lock-in replaces the old one. This only works while Act is still open: once every living player has locked in, Act closes about one second later.
- The screen stays awake during Act and Vote on phones that allow it.



20.2 Locked in, with CHANGE.

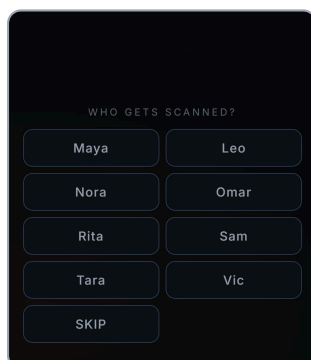


20.3 Round 2: Steering is marked BROKEN.

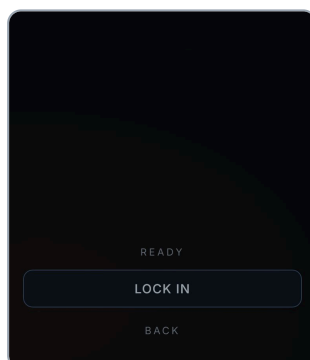


20.4 Report, Talk and Resolve.

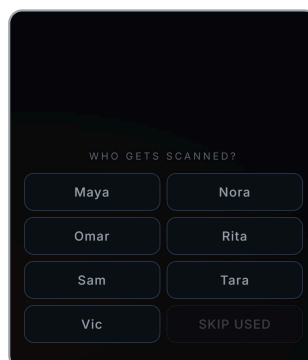
20.3 The ballot (two taps)



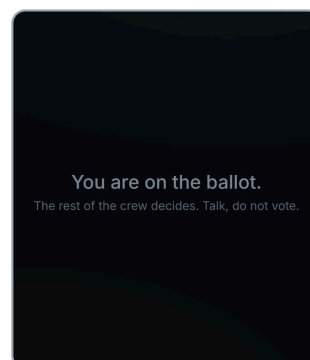
20.5 A first ballot: every living, unverified player and



20.6
LOCK IN
or
BACK



20.7 A player who already used their skip:



20.8 A runoff candidate's phone.

- Names appear in seating order (the order people joined), so tiles stay in the same place every round. With more than six names the tiles form two columns.
- Your own tile is disabled if self-voting is switched off.
- After **LOCK IN** the vote cannot be changed from the phone.
- If the server refuses a ballot (for example your skip was already used), the phone stays on the ballot so you can choose again.

21. Between rounds and the game-over screen

21.1 The role reveal screen on the monitor

Before round 1: Round 1 is about to begin , Look at your phone , Hold the card to see who you are. Do not let a neighbour see it. , and either a big countdown (timed) or a big NEXT ► with or press Space (manual steps; Waiting for the host. on a non-host screen).

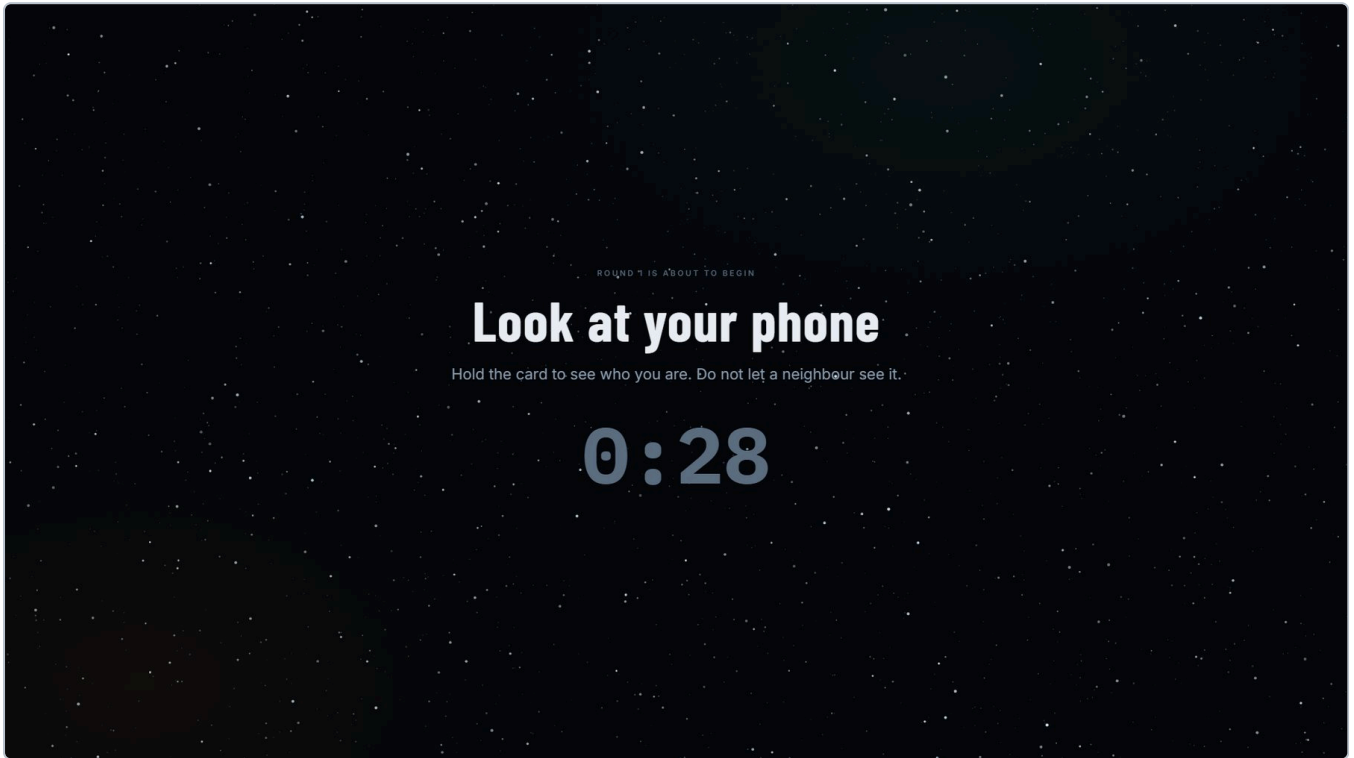


Figure 21.1 The role reveal in a timed game.

21.2 Game over

The monitor shows:

- Game over and the headline: The crew survives (teal) or The Mimics win (red), with the reason line from section 17.1.
- The Infection meter as it ended.
- A card for **every player with their true role**; Mimic cards are outlined in red.
- The settings line, so the table can see what they played.
- ← Back to main menu (this closes the game for every screen).
- The full ship log from round 1 (outcomes only; individual ballots are not repeated). With bots, the whole crew chat is shown beside it, with every line spoken by a Mimic marked Mimic .

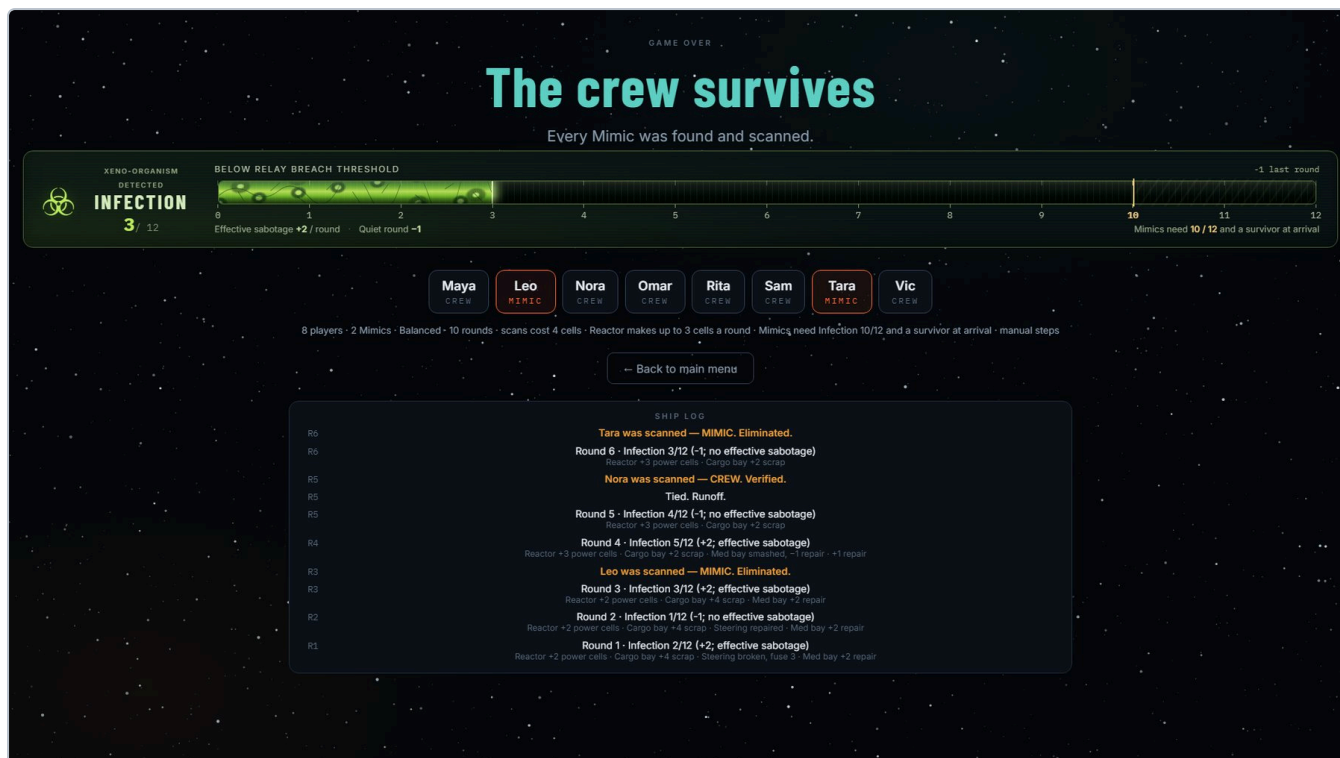


Figure 21.2 The game-over screen after the crew scanned both Mimics.

22. Leaving, quitting and removing players

Action	Who / when	Effect
✕ on a roster name	Host, lobby only	Removes that player or bot. A human's phone returns to the menu with <code>The host removed you from the room. You can join again.</code>
← Main menu in the lobby	Host	With nobody joined: leaves at once. Otherwise asks <code>Close this room?</code> ; <code>Close room</code> sends everyone back to the menu and deletes the game.
✕ Quit in the header	Host, during a game	Asks <code>Quit this game?</code> / <code>The game ends for everyone, nobody wins</code> , and every screen goes back to the main menu. <code>Quit game</code> confirms; Cancel (or <code>Esc</code>) keeps playing. The dialog opens with Cancel selected, so a stray Enter never ends the game.
← Back to main menu on game over	Host	Closes the finished game; phones still on it return to the menu with <code>The host ended the game.</code>
MAIN MENU on a phone at game over	Any player	That phone leaves the finished game and returns to the menu.
A player leaves mid-game	Anyone	Players cannot be removed once the game has started. A player who stops using their phone stays in the game: each round they automatically work in their last room, and they cast no ballots.

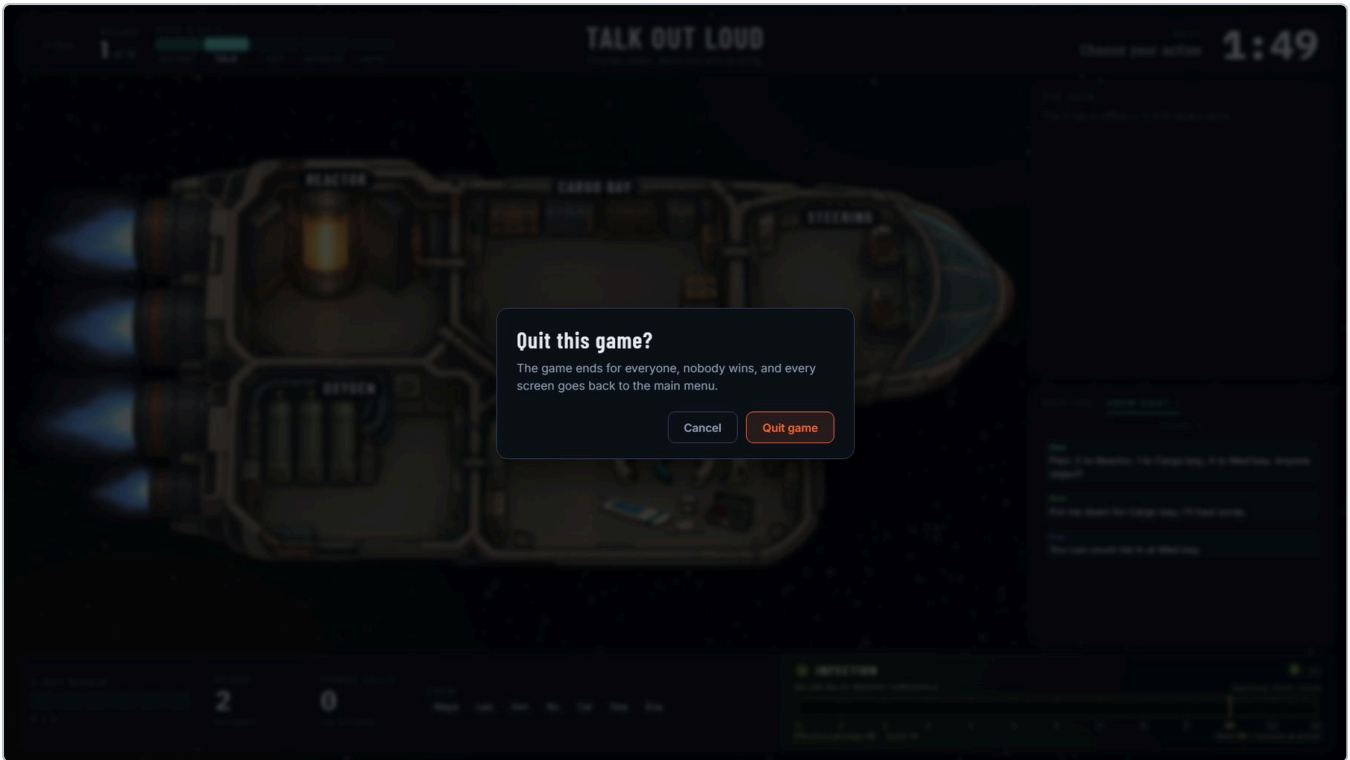
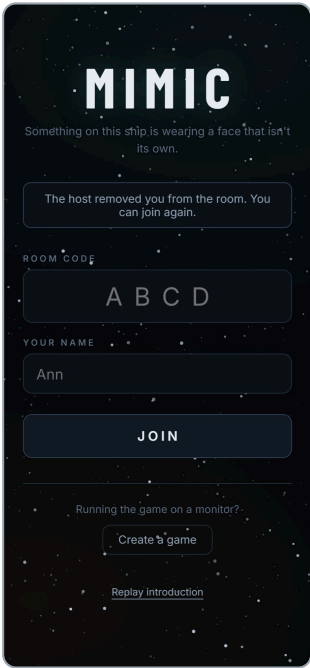
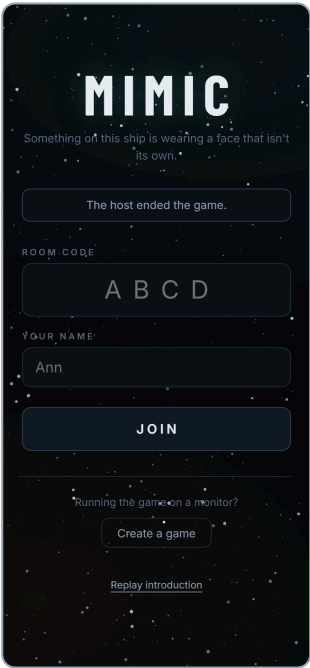


Figure 22.1 The quit confirmation.



22.2 A removed player's phone.



22.3 After the host quits.

Part IV · Modes, bots and technical behaviour

How the evening runs, how the app keeps secrets, and what to do when something goes wrong

23. How the app keeps secrets

MIMIC is designed so that **nothing on any phone, and nothing on the monitor, can reveal a role**, except the role card itself and the result of a scan. Knowing these features helps players trust the game and avoid giving themselves away.

Feature	Why it exists
Identical screens and buttons for both roles	A Mimic's phone shows exactly the same screens, buttons, colours, text and number of taps as a crew phone, every round. The test suite checks that both render identical pixels.
Crew SABO is harmless	So pressing SABO is not suspicious in itself, and a Mimic's thumb looks like anyone else's.
Invalid sabotage is never refused	If the server refused an illegal sabotage, only a Mimic could ever see a refusal. Instead it silently becomes work.
Shuffled focus tiles and buttons	The positions of the tiles and of WORK / SABO change per player per round, so nobody can read a choice from where a finger lands.
0.7-second tap guard and fades	Every player's tapping rhythm is the same, and accidental double taps are ignored.
Locked-in counter updates every 5 s	You cannot match the counter's change to the moment a neighbour lowered their phone.
Map hidden during Act	Nobody's intended room is shown until everyone is committed.
Grey on black phone screens	Readable at arm's length, hard to read from the next seat.
Hold-to-reveal role card, same shape for both roles	Both cards have two lines of similar length. The crew motto is filler so the shape matches.
The role is deleted after the reveal	After the Roles phase, the phone no longer holds the role anywhere, so it cannot be recovered from the phone later.
No sound, vibration or notification on phones	A phone must never light up or buzz on its own, which would single someone out.
Screen kept awake in Act and Vote	So no phone wakes up at a different moment than the others.

Feature	Why it exists
Reports show totals only	The report never says who produced, who repaired, which dice rolled what, or who sabotaged. The Infection meter shows <i>that</i> sabotage happened, never <i>who</i> .
Private data goes to one phone only	The role card goes only to its owner's phone. Spectator data goes only to eliminated players. Everything else sent to phones is public and identical.

24. Table etiquette

These are not enforced by the app, but the game only works if everyone follows them.

- **Never show your phone** to anyone, and do not look at other people's phones.
- **Phones down during Talk.** Look at the monitor and at each other.
- Hold your phone low and close; cover the role card with your other hand.
- **Take roughly the same time** on your phone every Act. Do not rush or hesitate in a way that stands out.
- Crew should press **SABO** sometimes. It is harmless and it protects the Mimics' cover, which protects everyone's anonymity.
- **Eliminated players stay silent.** The spectator view shows every role; revealing it ruins the game.
- You may lie about your own action out loud, whatever your role. Only the monitor tells the truth.
- Bots cannot hear you. You can argue with them, but they will not answer.

25. Timings at a glance

Step	Normal (default)	Custom range	Fast phases (dev)	Manual steps
Role reveal	30 s	fixed	5 s	Until Next
Report	20 s	5–60 s	3 s	Until Next
Talk	150 s	30–600 s	4 s	Until Next
Act	60 s	20–180 s	10 s	Until everyone locks in, or Next
Resolve	30 s	10–90 s	4 s	Until Next
Vote (each ballot)	60 s	20–180 s	10 s	Until everyone votes, or Next
Vote result on screen	8 s	fixed	3 s	Until Next

- In every mode, Act closes about 1 second after the last living player locks in, and a ballot closes about 1 second after the last eligible voter votes.
- A runoff with nobody able to vote (every living player is a candidate) closes after 1 second as a tie.
- With default timings a round without a vote lasts at most 4 minutes 20 seconds (20 + 150 + 60 + 30 s), and a vote adds up to 68 seconds more (a runoff adds the same again). A 10-round game therefore takes up to about 50–55 minutes, less when players lock in and vote quickly.

26. Manual steps

With `Manual steps` on, there are no countdowns. The host decides when the table is ready to move on.

- The header shows `NEXT ▶` instead of a clock. The role reveal shows a big `NEXT ▶`.
- **Keyboard:** `Space`, `→` or `Page Down` press Next, so a presentation clicker works. Keys are ignored while typing in a field, while a button has focus, while the quit dialog is open, and in the lobby or on the game-over screen. Holding a key down does not repeat.
- **Double presses can never skip a step.** Each press carries the step it was made on; a second press for an old step is ignored. Every new step also ignores Next for 1.5 seconds.
- **Act and open ballots wait for players.** While someone has not locked in or voted, Next is disabled for up to 15 seconds from the start of that step, and shows `waiting for N`. After 15 seconds the host can press Next anyway; anyone who has not locked in gets the default action (work in their last room) and anyone who has not voted casts no ballot.
- Act and ballots still close **on their own** as soon as everyone is in.
- The vote result stays on screen until Next.
- The role reveal lasts as long as the host wants. (Timed games fix it at 30 seconds so that nobody notices who looked at their card longest.)
- Bots still talk: in Talk they speak during roughly the first minute.
- Only the host screen can press Next. Other screens show `The host moves on`.
- `Fast phases` cannot be used with Manual steps.

27. Votes hidden

- Only a vote's **outcome** is shown: who was scanned and what they were, that nobody was scanned, or that there is a runoff (and between whom, because players must vote for them).
- Ballots never leave the server. They are not in the vote panel, not in the log, not on the game-over screen and not in any data sent to phones or the monitor.
- Who *has* voted is still shown while a ballot is open, because that is participation, not a result.
- The vote panel says `Ballots are secret and stay secret. Only the result is shown.` during voting and `Votes are hidden in this game.` after.
- Bots never say whom they voted for in this mode, and they do not use ballots as evidence.
- The settings line includes `votes hidden`.

28. Fast phases (developer mode)

`Fast phases (dev)` cuts every phase to a few seconds (see the table in section 25) so a whole ten-round game with bots takes two or three minutes. Act and Vote stay long enough for a human to tap through. Bots say only one quick line each. It is meant for testing, not for real play. It cannot be combined with Manual steps.

29. Bots

Bots fill empty seats. They are real players: they get a role (and can be a Mimic), stand in rooms, sabotage, vote and talk. They play only from information a human at the table could see, plus their own role card.

29.1 Adding and removing bots

- Press **+ Bot** in the lobby. Each press seats one bot.
- Bots are named from the list **Ann, Bo, Cal, Dee, Eva, Fin, Gus, Hal, Ivy, Jun, Kit, Lux**, taking the first name not already used.
- They appear in the roster with a dashed border and a **bot** badge. On the map and in the crew list they look like everyone else.
- Remove a bot with **x** like any player. Bots cannot be added or removed after the start.
- Bots count towards the 12-player limit and the 3-player minimum.

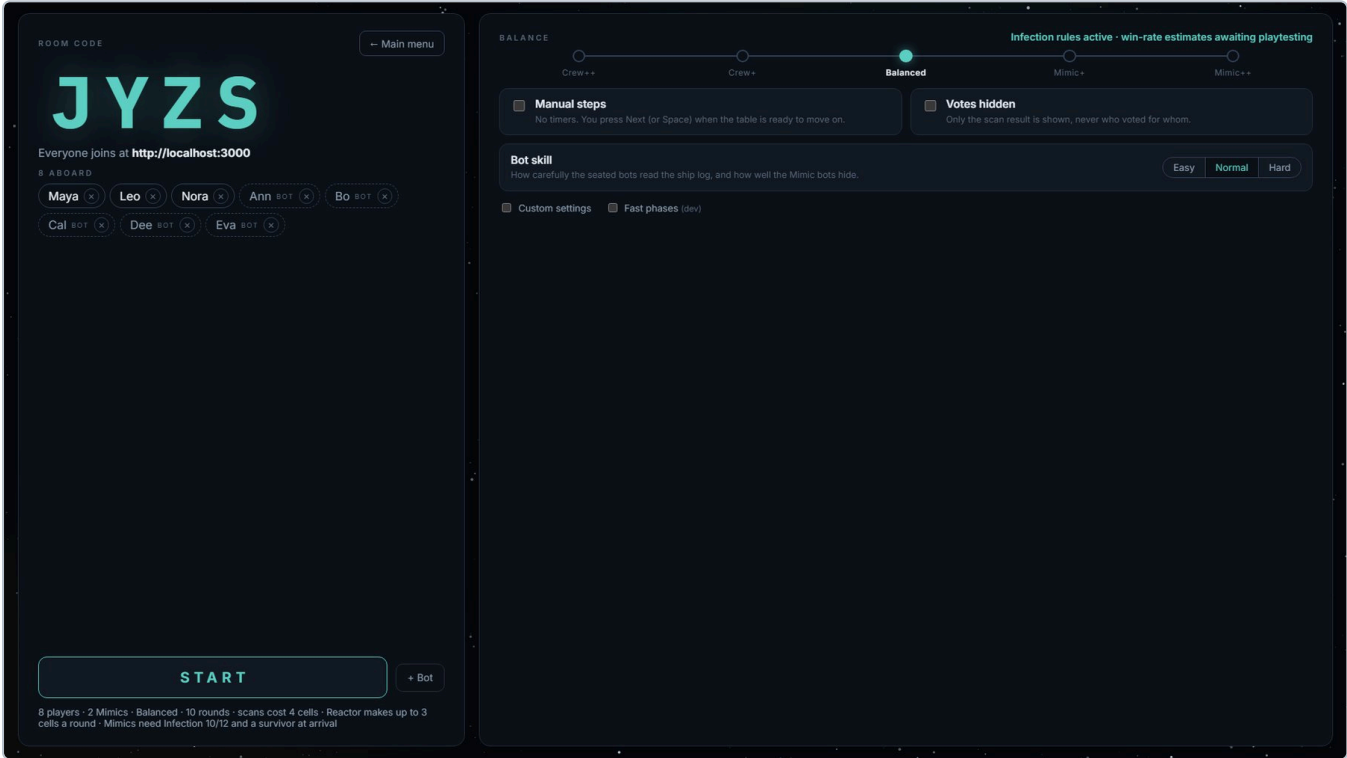


Figure 29.1 A lobby with two humans and five bots.

29.2 Bot skill

Skill	How the bots behave
Easy	Noisy and forgetful. They often wander to a random room instead of following the plan, accuse sooner on weaker evidence, and forget evidence faster. Easy Mimic bots sabotage on a coin flip and pick sabotages at random.
Normal	The default. Some randomness, sensible plans. Mimic bots usually pick one of their best sabotages.
Hard	Cold and precise. They never wander, weigh evidence strictly and forget slowly. Hard Mimic bots always pick the best sabotage and care much more about having cover (other people in rooms that could also have done it).

29.3 How bots think

- **Reading the report.** A break makes every player who stood in a room it could have come from a suspect. A shortfall in scrap or cells that production and spending cannot explain is treated as theft by the people in that room. Output lower than the number of workers suggests is suspicious. A Med bay round far below the odds is weak evidence against its occupants.
- **Reading votes** (when visible): players who voted for a caught Mimic gain trust; players who did not vote for them look like they were shielding; players who pushed a scan onto a crew member look suspicious.
- **Listening to each other.** Bots hear other bots' accusations and adjust, weighted by how much they trust the speaker. Bots never hear humans.
- **Crew plan.** Bots share a plan built from public state: repair broken rooms first (a fuse at 1 beats everything), then keep scrap and Med bay attempts balanced, then fill the Reactor up to its cap. Once the X-ray works they keep a couple of funded repair attempts ready in case of a smash, save cells for scans and guard Steering and Oxygen. Duties rotate each round. Crew bots also press SABO about half the time, as the rules encourage.
- **Voting as crew.** A bot votes for its top suspect when the case is clear, scans more readily when cells are plentiful or time is running out, and otherwise uses its skip (once per game).
- **Mimic bots** score every possible sabotage by impact and cover, account for the work they give up, and value theft that prevents a scan this round. They lay low for a round when suspicion is high, but they switch to sabotaging when another quiet round would make an Infection win impossible. In Team mode the least-suspected Mimic bot acts. In Each mode Mimic bots avoid breaking the same room twice. They never vote for a teammate; they push the table's existing suspicion onto a crew member or skip.

29.4 Bot talk (the crew chat)

- Bots talk only on the monitor, in the **Crew chat** tab. Phones never show it.
- When Talk opens, each bot decides its round and then announces it, so **what a bot says it will do is what it does**. A Mimic bot's announcement is its cover story, and it may be a lie about its intentions.
- Each bot says at most two lines per Talk phase, and the whole table at most one line per bot plus two. Lines are a few seconds apart and finish well before Act so the humans have the last word (in manual steps, within about the first minute).
- Kinds of line: a round plan for the table, an announcement of where the bot will stand and why, an accusation with its evidence, agreeing or disagreeing with another bot's accusation, defending itself when accused, **no lead** remarks, a reaction to the round report (a break, a theft, the X-ray coming online, a smash), a reaction to the vote result and, with visible votes, a reason for its ballot.
- Four voices: **analytical**, **joker**, **terse** and **nervous**, assigned in turn. The wording never depends on a bot's role, so the style of a message gives nothing away.
- Bots avoid repeating themselves: the last 400 messages are kept, and exact repeats are avoided.
- A bot that is eliminated stops talking.
- At game over, the full chat is shown with every line said by a Mimic marked.

30. Connections, refreshing and reconnecting

Situation	What happens
A phone loses Wi-Fi briefly, locks, or the browser is backgrounded	It shows Reconnecting... and rejoins automatically when the connection returns, landing on the right screen for the current phase (including its Act options or ballot). Its pill is faded on the monitor while it is disconnected.
A player refreshes the page, or closes and reopens the tab	They rejoin automatically. The seat is remembered in that browser's storage.
A player's phone dies or they switch to another browser/device	They cannot get their seat back, because the seat is tied to the original browser. Their character keeps working in its last room each round and casts no ballots. Joining again as a new player is not possible after the start.
A phone in private/incognito mode	It can play, but may not be able to reconnect automatically if the page is reloaded.
A phone reconnects during the role reveal	The role card is sent again. After the reveal it is gone for good.
The host refreshes the monitor	Host powers are kept (the host key is stored in that browser for that room code).
The host's browser loses its storage, or another device opens the host address	It becomes a watch-only screen: it shows everything but cannot start the game, change settings, press Next or quit. There is no way to transfer host powers.
The game server stops or restarts	Every game is lost. Phones return to the menu when they reconnect. Start a new game.
A player's phone shows a finished or closed game	It returns to the main menu.

31. Troubleshooting

Problem	Try this
Phones cannot open the address	Make sure phones are on the same network as the server. Use the "On this network" address, not localhost . Check the computer's firewall allows port 3000. Some guest Wi-Fi networks block devices from reaching each other.
No game with that code.	Check the code on the monitor (no I or O). The game may have been closed or the server restarted.
That game has already started.	You cannot join mid-game. Wait for the next game.
The server did not answer.	The connection is poor or the server is down. Reload and try again.
START is disabled	Fewer than 3 players are seated, or this screen is not the host.
The monitor says This browser is not the host...	This browser did not create the game. Use the browser that did, or create a new game.

Problem	Try this
Next does not respond	Wait for the short settling pause; during Act or a ballot, wait until everyone is in or 15 seconds have passed (waiting for N).
No vote this round	Read the vote panel: X-ray offline, not enough cells, or too few players. A theft or smash during the round may have caused it.
A player's phone stuck on Loading...	Reload the page. If the game no longer exists, the phone returns to the menu.
The phone says Turn your phone upright.	Rotate the phone to portrait, or turn on rotation lock.
The introduction has no sound	The browser blocked audio. Press play again or use Sound on ; check the device volume.
A player cannot see their role any more	That is by design; the card exists only during the reveal. They must remember it.
Want to see who voted for whom later	Not possible: ballots are shown only while the vote result is on screen. Note them down.

Part V · Strategy

How to find the Mimics, and how to hide as one

Everything in this part is **advice**, derived from the rules in Part II. None of it is a rule. The facts it relies on (who can break what, how resources are counted) are exact.

32. The deduction toolkit

The crew has four sources of hard evidence. Everything else is talk.

Source	What it proves
Positions	Who stood where. Public after every round. Combined with pipe ranges, it limits who could have caused each event.
Room output	Whether everyone in a room really worked. Fewer scrap, cells or repair attempts than the head count allows means somebody there did something else.
Resource pools	Whether anything was stolen. The pools follow exact arithmetic (section 34).
The Infection meter	Whether any effective sabotage happened this round (+2) or none did (–1), including invisible corrupts.
Ballots (unless hidden)	Who voted for whom. A caught Mimic's voters, and the players who pushed a scan onto crew, are worth remembering.
Scans	The only proof of a role. Verified crew are certainly crew and make trustworthy partners.

TIP: WRITE IT DOWN

At every Report phase, note scrap, power cells and repair progress. At every Resolve, note who stood where and the room summaries. Ballots disappear after the vote result, and the monitor log only shows about three rounds.

33. Breaks and smashes: who could have done it

Event	Possible saboteur rooms	Notes
Reactor newly broken	Cargo bay, Oxygen, Med bay	Never from the Reactor itself. Anyone standing only in the Reactor or Steering is cleared of this break.

Event	Possible saboteur rooms	Notes
Steering newly broken	Steering, Cargo bay, Med bay	Reactor and Oxygen occupants are cleared.
Oxygen newly broken	Oxygen, Reactor, Med bay	Cargo bay and Steering occupants are cleared.
X-ray smashed	Reactor, Steering, Oxygen	Cargo bay and Med bay occupants are cleared.
A room shows repaired but was not broken at the start of the round	Same as a new break of that room	It was broken and repaired in the same round. It still counted for Infection.

- **Med bay occupants can break three rooms.** They are suspects for any break of the Reactor, Steering or Oxygen.
- **Cargo bay occupants can break two** (Reactor, Steering) and steal scrap.
- **A lone occupant** of a room that breaks from the inside (Steering, Oxygen) with nobody in the neighbouring rooms is the only possible culprit.
- Each player makes one action, so two events in the same round (two breaks, or a break and a theft) mean **at least two Mimics** acted. This is only possible in **Each** mode. It also tells you that at least two different rooms' suspect lists each contain a Mimic.
- Output shortfalls confirm suspicion: a saboteur does not produce. If the Cargo bay had 4 people but made +6 scrap, exactly one of them did not work that round. Combine this with the break table.

EXAMPLE

Round 1: Steering is broken. Positions: Reactor Tara; Cargo bay Omar, Rita, Sam, Vic (+6 scrap); Med bay Maya, Leo, Nora; Steering empty. Steering can be broken from Steering, Cargo bay or Med bay. The Cargo bay made 6 scrap from 4 people, so one of Omar, Rita, Sam and Vic did not work. The simplest explanation is that the saboteur was in the Cargo bay. Tara is cleared of the break. (In the real game, Rita did it.)

34. Resource accounting: catching thefts and idle hands

34.1 The arithmetic of a round

Let **S** and **C** be scrap and cells at the start of the round (as shown during Report and Talk).

```
Scrap after Resolve = max(0, S - 2 × scrap thefts) + (Cargo bay output) - (paid Med bay attempts)
Cells after Resolve = max(0, C - 2 × cell thefts) + (Reactor output)
Cells after a scan = Cells after Resolve - scan cost
```

- Cargo bay and Reactor output are printed on the map (**+6 scrap**, **+3 power cells**).
- **Paid Med bay attempts** = the number of Med bay **workers** (while the X-ray is offline), limited by the scrap available. A Mimic who corrupts or breaks from the Med bay is not a worker and pays nothing.
- If cells after Resolve are lower than **C + Reactor output**, cells were stolen by someone in the Reactor.

- If scrap after Resolve is lower than $S + \text{Cargo output} - \text{Med bay occupants}$, scrap was stolen by someone in the Cargo bay.

34.2 Output shortfalls

Room	Expected output with k people	If it is lower, somebody there...
Cargo bay	$2 \times k$ scrap	stole scrap, or broke the Reactor or Steering. (The Cargo bay never needs repair, so there is no innocent reason.)
Reactor	$\min(k, \text{cap})$ cells; one fewer if the Reactor was repaired this round	stole cells, broke Oxygen, or smashed the X-ray. When k is above the cap, a missing worker may not show.
Med bay	k paid attempts (visible as scrap spent)	corrupted a repair, or broke the Reactor, Steering or Oxygen. Scrap spent will be lower than k.
Steering, Oxygen	nothing to measure	These rooms produce nothing, so an idle saboteur there leaves no shortfall. Only a break shows.

WATCH OUT FOR

- The Reactor cap hides idle workers: 5 people and a cap of 3 still make 3.
- A **repair** uses one worker in a broken room. $\text{repaired} \cdot +2 \text{ power cells}$ from 3 Reactor workers is normal.
- A theft from a small pool is capped at what was there.
- In **Team** mode, extra sabotages silently become work, so a Mimic can press SABO and still produce.
- Players who did not lock in work in their previous room, which can put someone in a room they did not announce.

35. Repairs, probability and corrupts

Each paid attempt succeeds 60 % of the time (by default). Bad luck is common with few attempts and rare with many.

Paid attempts	Expected points	Chance of 0 points	Chance of 1 or fewer	Chance of all succeeding
1	0.6	40 %	100 %	60 %
2	1.2	16 %	64 %	36 %
3	1.8	6.4 %	35 %	22 %
4	2.4	2.6 %	18 %	13 %
5	3.0	1.0 %	8.7 %	7.8 %
6	3.6	0.4 %	4.1 %	4.7 %

- Reaching 6 points needs about 10 paid attempts on average, so the X-ray usually comes online in round 3 or 4 when the crew commits.

- **Spotting a corrupt:** the Infection meter rises by 2, no room was newly broken or repaired, no smash, and no resources went missing. The only remaining effective sabotage is a corrupt, and **a corrupt can only come from the Med bay**. Also, the Med bay spent one scrap fewer than its head count.
- A corrupt only works if another Med bay worker paid for an attempt, so a Mimic alone in the Med bay cannot corrupt anything.

36. Reading the Infection meter

Meter this round	What it tells you
-1 (or 0 at the bottom)	No effective sabotage happened at all. If a room still produced less than its head count allows, someone there made a sabotage that failed : a theft from an empty pool, or a corrupt with no paid attempt to ruin. (Other invalid sabotages turn into ordinary work and leave no shortfall.) That player is almost certainly a Mimic.
+2 with a visible break, smash or theft	Consistent with the visible event. There may also be hidden extra sabotage in Each mode.
+2 with nothing visible	A corrupt in the Med bay (section 35).
Several quiet rounds in a row	The Mimics are laying low. They cannot afford it for long: each quiet round costs them 1 and needs a later active round to recover.

Countdown to arrival. With R rounds left (including the current one) and Infection I , the most the Mimics can reach is $I + 2R$ (capped at 12). If that is below 10, they can no longer win by arrival; only a hull breach or the crew mis-scanning everyone keeps them in the game. Conversely, if Infection is high near the end, the crew **must** scan a Mimic or keep the Mimics from sabotaging.

37. Playing well

37.1 As the crew

- **Agree a plan out loud in Talk.** Say where you will stand. A player who ends up somewhere else has some explaining to do.
- **Early game:** balance the Cargo bay (scrap) and the Med bay (attempts). Scrap made this round pays for this round's attempts. Put a few people in the Reactor so cells are ready when the X-ray comes online.
- **Repair broken rooms promptly.** One worker in the room is enough. A fuse at 1 is an emergency.
- **Guard rooms.** A room with a crew member working in it is repaired the same round it is broken. Leaving Steering and Oxygen empty invites cheap breaks.
- **After the X-ray is online:** keep one or two people in the Med bay with scrap available, so a smash can be undone the same round. Keep the Reactor staffed to afford scans.
- **Spread Med bay suspects thin.** Med bay occupants can break three rooms; do not send your only verified player there if you want them as an alibi elsewhere.
- **Use your skip wisely.** You get one per game. Skipping saves 4 cells when there is no good lead, but a scan on a coin flip still verifies someone.
- **Verified players are anchors.** They cannot be Mimics. Pair them with suspects to test alibis.

- **Remember the ballots** of every scan. Who did not vote for a caught Mimic?
- **Watch the meter near the end.** If Infection is 8 or more with a few rounds left, scanning a Mimic or stopping every sabotage becomes urgent.
- **Press SABO sometimes.** It does nothing for you, but it keeps SABO meaningless as a tell.

37.2 As a Mimic

- **Infection is your clock.** You need at least five effective sabotage rounds from 0. Do not wait: from round 7 of 10 it is too late to start. Aim for 12 so you can afford quiet rounds at the end.
- **Sabotage from crowded rooms.** The more innocent people stood in rooms that could have done it, the safer you are. The Med bay reaches three breakable rooms.
- **Break empty rooms.** A break into an occupied room is repaired immediately. It still gives Infection, but it barely hurts the crew.
- **Mind the output.** A saboteur produces nothing. In the Cargo bay that shortfall is obvious; in Steering or Oxygen it is invisible.
- **Theft before a vote.** Stealing 2 cells in the Reactor can drop the pool below the scan cost and cancel this round's vote.
- **The smash.** Once the X-ray is online, a smash from the Reactor, Steering or Oxygen delays scans. It works best when few crew are in the Med bay to win the point back.
- **Corrupts are quiet but traceable:** the meter rises with nothing visible, which points straight at the Med bay.
- **Coordinate with your teammates** only through public talk. In **Each** mode do not aim at the same room. In **Team** mode only one sabotage lands, so extra ones just become work.
- **Fuses:** breaking two rooms in different rounds, or a room the crew keeps ignoring, can force a hull breach. Three rounds is enough time for an attentive crew, so it works best when they are distracted.
- **Voting:** push suspicion that already exists onto a crew member; avoid being the only person who did not vote for a caught teammate.
- **Lie consistently.** Announce a plan and mostly follow it. Being seen in the wrong room is the easiest way to get scanned.

Part VI · Reference

Quick lookups, every message, a long FAQ and a glossary

38. Quick deduction tables

38.1 Adjacency (pipes)

Room	Reactor	Cargo bay	Steering	Oxygen	Med bay
Reactor	–	•		•	•
Cargo bay	•	–	•		
Steering		•	–		•
Oxygen	•			–	•
Med bay	•		•	•	–

38.2 What a Mimic in each room can do (rows) to each target (columns)

Mimic in ↓ / focus →	Reactor	Cargo bay	Steering	Oxygen	Med bay
Reactor	steal cells	–	n/a	break	smash*
Cargo bay	break	steal scrap	break	n/a	n/a
Steering	n/a	–	break	n/a	smash*
Oxygen	break	n/a	n/a	break	smash*
Med bay	break	n/a	break	break	corrupt

“–” = offered as a focus but has no effect (works instead). “n/a” = not offered as a focus (no pipe). * only while the X-ray is online. Breaks only work on a room that is not already broken.

38.3 Event → suspects

Event	Suspect rooms	How it shows
Reactor broken	Cargo bay, Oxygen, Med bay	Hazard border, or repaired on a room that was fine
Steering broken	Steering, Cargo bay, Med bay	Same
Oxygen broken	Oxygen, Reactor, Med bay	Same

Event	Suspect rooms	How it shows
X-ray smashed	Reactor, Steering, Oxygen	smashed , -1 repair
Cells stolen	Reactor	Cells lower than start + output
Scrap stolen	Cargo bay	Scrap lower than start + output – Med bay attempts
Corrupt	Med bay	Infection +2 with nothing else visible; one scrap fewer spent
Cargo bay output below 2 × head count	Cargo bay	Someone there stole or broke
Reactor output below head count (under the cap, allowing for a repair)	Reactor	Someone there stole, broke Oxygen or smashed

39. One-page rules summary

SETUP

3–12 players (6+ recommended). Mimics: 1 (≤5 players), 2 (6–9), 3 (10–12). Roles secret; Mimics see each other once. Start: scrap 2, cells 0, X-ray 0/6, Infection 0.

ROUND

Report (fuses –1, breach check) → Talk → Act (room, focus, WORK/SABO, lock in) → Resolve → Vote (only if X-ray online, cells ≥ scan cost, ≥2 alive). 10 rounds.

ROOMS

Reactor +1 cell/worker, cap 3/round (6 at 10–12 players). Cargo bay +2 scrap/worker. Med bay: 1 scrap per attempt, 60 % → +1 repair; nothing once online. Steering, Oxygen: nothing. Pipes: R–C, C–S, S–M, M–O, O–R, R–M.

CREW

Always works, whatever the focus or button.

MIMIC SABO

Own room: Med bay corrupt · Cargo steal 2 scrap · Reactor steal 2 cells · Steering/Oxygen break it. Neighbour: break Reactor/Steering/Oxygen if not broken; smash Med bay if X-ray online. Anything else = work.

SABOTAGES PER ROUND

Each (default): all land. Team: one random lands, others become work.

RESOLUTION ORDER

Defaults → sabotage (breaks, smash, thefts) → repairs (1 worker per broken room) → production (cap) → Med bay attempts (corrupts ruin paid attempts) → Infection → report → vote.

FUSES

Fuse 3 when broken; –1 at each later Report; 0 = Mimics win. Repair in rounds N, N+1 or N+2.

INFECTION

0–12. +2 once per round if any sabotage had an effect; otherwise –1. Arrival: Mimic alive and ≥10 → Mimics win; below 10 → crew wins.

VOTE

Choices: living unverified players + SKIP (one skip per player per game). SKIP in top → no scan. One top player → scan. Tie → runoff among tied; they don't vote; no skip; tie again → no scan.

SCAN

Costs 4 cells (5 at 10–12). Mimic → eliminated (spectator). Crew → verified, off future ballots.

GAME ENDS

Fuse burns out → Mimics. Last Mimic scanned → crew.
After last round: Mimic alive & Infection ≥ 10 → Mimics; else crew.

40. Every message and label

40.1 Main menu and joining

Text	Where / meaning
Something on this ship is wearing a face that isn't its own.	Menu tagline
Running the game on a monitor? / Create a game	Menu, for the host
Replay introduction	Menu
The host ended the game.	Menu notice after a quit or closed room
The host removed you from the room. You can join again.	Menu notice after removal
The room code is 4 letters. · Enter your name. · Enter a name. · No game with that code. · That game has already started. · That game is full. · That name is taken. · The server did not answer. · Could not join.	Join errors (section 4.2)
Could not create a game.	Create failed (server unreachable)

40.2 Lobby and host

Text	Where / meaning
Room code · Everyone joins at ... · N aboard · Nobody yet.	Lobby
Needs at least 3 to start. Six is the recommended minimum.	Lobby, under 3 players
Need at least 3 players (6 is the recommended minimum).	Start refused
Watching only – the host screen has the START button.	Lobby on a non-host screen
Looking for game ABCD... · Connecting...	Host screen loading. Stays on “Looking for game” if the game no longer exists.

Text	Where / meaning
This browser is not the host of ABCD. It will show the game, but cannot start it.	Non-host screen loading
Infection rules active · win-rate estimates awaiting playtesting	Above the Balance slider
Close this room? / Everyone who has joined is sent back to the main menu. / Close room	Leaving a lobby with players
Quit this game? / The game ends for everyone, nobody wins, and every screen goes back to the main menu. / Quit game	Quit dialog
Settings are frozen once the game starts. · Players can only be removed in the lobby. · Not the host.	Refused host actions

40.3 In game (monitor)

Text	Where / meaning
Round 1 is about to begin · Look at your phone · Hold the card to see who you are. Do not let a neighbour see it. · or press Space · Waiting for the host.	Role reveal
Ship report · Talk out loud · Choose your action · What happened · Vote · Game over	Phase titles
Phones down. Work out who is lying. · Room, focus, button, lock in.	Subtitles in Talk and Act
Next · Round N · Ship report · Vote result · Runoff vote	Header “next” label
or Space · waiting for N · ... · The host moves on	Beside Next
Step N of 5 / of 4 · No vote · Runoff	Step track
Locked in N / M	Map during Act
FUSE N	Broken room badge
X-ray repair · ONLINE · Scrap · for repairs · Power cells · cap N / round · scan costs N · Crew	Status strip

Text	Where / meaning
Xeno-organism detected · INFECTION · Below relay breach threshold · Relay defences compromised · Awaiting first round · ±N last round · Effective sabotage +2 · Quiet -1 · Need 10 + survivor at arrival	Infection meter
Vote panel texts	See section 19.1
Ship log · Crew chat · Nothing has happened yet. · a quiet round · The bots have nothing to say yet.	Right rail
Round N · Infection I/12 (+2; effective sabotage) · (-1; no effective sabotage)	Log round line
X was scanned – MIMIC. Eliminated. · X was scanned – CREW. Verified. · The crew skipped the scan. · Tied. Runoff. · Runoff tied. No scan.	Log vote lines
The Steering fuse burned out. Hull breach. · Infection 11/12. A surviving Mimic breached the relay's defences. · Infection 7/12, below 10. Relay screening destroyed the remaining Mimics.	Log end lines (with the actual numbers)
The crew survives · The Mimics win and the four reason lines (section 17.1) · ← Back to main menu	Game over

40.4 Phone

Text	Where / meaning
You're in. · Look at the monitor. · Loading... · Reconnecting...	Waiting screens
Hold the card. Cover it with your other hand. · HOLD TO REVEAL · You are CREW. · You are a MIMIC. · With you: ... · You are the only one. Good luck.	Role card
Where do you stand? · Focus · Action · Ready · WORK · SABO · LOCK IN · BACK · broken	Action flow
Locked in. · CHANGE	After locking in
Who gets scanned? · Runoff · SKIP · SKIP USED	Ballot

Text	Where / meaning
You are on the ballot. · The rest of the crew decides. Talk, do not vote. · Votes are in.	Vote screens
Eliminated · spectator · Last round · Waiting for the next round. · Nothing has resolved yet. · Stay silent. Let them work it out.	Spectator view
Game over. · MAIN MENU · Turn your phone upright.	Other

41. Frequently asked questions

41.1 Setup and joining

Q How many people do we need?

A. At least 3 to start (bots count), at most 12. Six or more is recommended; five is a teaching game.

Q Do players need to install anything or make an account?

A. No. Players open a web address in their phone browser and type a room code and a name.

Q Do we need internet?

A. No. Phones only need to reach the server computer over the local network.

Q Can someone join after the game has started?

A. No. Joining is only possible in the lobby (That game has already started.).

Q Can two players have the same name?

A. No. Names must be unique, ignoring capital letters. Names are at most 12 characters.

Q Can I use the same name after being removed?

A. Yes. A removed player can rejoin straight away with any free name, including their old one.

Q Why is there no I or O in room codes?

A. They are easily confused with 1 and 0 when read from across a room.

Q Can I host from a phone?

A. Technically the host screen works in any browser, but it is designed for a large landscape screen that everyone can see.

Q Can one computer host several games in a row?

A. Yes. Each room code gets its own host key in that browser.

Q Can the monitor also be a player?

A. The host screen is not a player. A person at the monitor who wants to play must join on their own phone. Note that the host screen shows nothing secret, so this is fair.

Q. How long does a game take?

A. A timed 10-round game with default phase lengths takes up to about 50–55 minutes; faster if everyone locks in quickly. With manual steps it is as long as the table wants. See section 25.

41.2 Roles

Q. How are roles chosen?

A. Randomly by the server at the moment the host presses START.

Q. Do Mimics know each other?

A. Yes, their role card names the other Mimics. They see it only during the role reveal.

Q. I forgot my role. Can I see it again?

A. No. The card exists only during the role reveal phase and is then deleted from the phone.

Q. Can a bot be a Mimic?

A. Yes. Bots get roles exactly like humans.

Q. Can roles change during the game?

A. No. There is no conversion or role swap.

Q. Can there be more Mimics than crew?

A. Only with Custom settings (up to 4 Mimics). If the Mimic count is at least the number of players, everyone is a Mimic.

Q. Can a crew member be killed or eliminated?

A. No. Only scanned Mimics are eliminated. A scanned crew member is verified instead.

41.3 Actions

Q. What happens if a crew member presses SABO?

A. They work exactly as if they pressed WORK. Nothing is recorded anywhere.

Q. What does the focus do for crew?

A. Nothing. Only a Mimic's SABO uses the focus.

Q. Can a Mimic press WORK?

A. Yes. A Mimic pressing WORK works normally, producing resources and repairing like crew.

Q. Can I stand in any room?

A. Yes, every round, regardless of where you were before. Pipes only limit sabotage range.

Q. What if I don't lock in in time?

A. You work in the room you stood in last round (the Cargo bay in round 1). You cannot sabotage by timing out.

Q. Can I change my action after locking in?

A. Yes, press **CHANGE** while Act is still open. Once the last living player locks in, Act closes about a second later.

Q. Does anyone see my room before Resolve?

A. No. The map hides all positions during Act.

Q. What if a Mimic picks an invalid sabotage?

A. It silently becomes work in their chosen room. The phone does not warn them.

Q. Can the Reactor be broken by someone inside it?

A. No. Inside the Reactor, SABO on the Reactor steals cells. It can only be broken from the Cargo bay, Oxygen or the Med bay.

Q. Can the Cargo bay be broken?

A. Never.

Q. Can the Med bay be broken?

A. It never gets a fuse. Once the X-ray is online, it can be smashed from the Reactor, Steering or Oxygen, which removes one repair point.

Q. Can a Mimic break Steering from the Reactor?

A. No, there is no pipe between them. Steering can be broken from Steering, the Cargo bay or the Med bay.

Q. Can a Mimic steal from a room other than the one they stand in?

A. No. Scrap can only be stolen in the Cargo bay and cells only in the Reactor, by focusing that same room.

Q. Can two Mimics break the same room?

A. The room breaks once. The second sabotage has no extra effect.

Q. Can a Mimic sabotage twice in a round?

A. No. Every player has exactly one action per round.

Q. In Team mode, what happens to the Mimics whose sabotage was not picked?

A. Their action becomes work in the room they chose: they produce and can repair. Nobody is told.

Q. Can a Mimic corrupt when alone in the Med bay?

A. It has no effect: a corrupt ruins another worker's paid attempt, and there is none.

41.4 Resources, repairs and fuses

Q. Why did the Reactor make only 3 cells with 5 workers?

A. The Reactor cap (3 by default for up to 9 players) limits output per round.

Q. Can scrap made this round pay for this round's repairs?

A. Yes. Production happens before the Med bay attempts.

Q. What if there is not enough scrap for everyone in the Med bay?

A. Attempts that cannot be paid do nothing and cost nothing.

Q. What happens in the Med bay after the X-ray is online?

A. Nothing: no attempts, no scrap spent, the report says **nothing to do**. Standing there is still useful, because if the X-ray is smashed that same round, those workers make attempts to win the point back.

Q. How many people does it take to repair a broken room?

A. One. Any one worker in the room repairs it. Other workers there still produce.

Q. Does the repairer have to be crew?

A. No. Anyone whose action is work in that room counts, including a Mimic who pressed WORK.

Q. If a room is broken while I am working in it, what happens?

A. It is repaired in the same round (by you or another worker there), costing one worker's output. It still counts as effective sabotage for Infection.

Q. How long do we have to repair a broken room?

A. Broken in round N: repair it in round N, N+1 or N+2. At the start of round N+3 the ship is lost.

Q. Can a room broken in the final round destroy the ship?

A. No. Fuses are only checked at the start of a round, and no round follows the last one.

Q. Do resources carry over between rounds?

A. Yes. Pools never reset and have no maximum.

Q. Can pools go negative?

A. No. A theft from a small pool stops at 0.

Q. Is the repair roll random for every attempt?

A. Yes, independently at the repair chance (60 %). Corrupted attempts always fail.

41.5 Infection

Q. Does each sabotage add 2?

A. No. Infection rises by 2 at most once per round, however many effective sabotages happened.

Q. Does a break that is repaired immediately count?

A. Yes. A new break counts even if repaired in the same round.

Q. Does a room that stays broken keep adding Infection?

A. No. Only new sabotage in the current round counts.

Q. Does stealing from an empty pool count?

A. No.

Q. Does a corrupt count if the attempt would have failed anyway?

A. Yes, as long as it ruined a paid attempt.

Q. If Infection reaches 10 in round 6, do the Mimics win?

A. No. Only the level at arrival (after the final round) matters, and it can still fall.

Q. Why did the log say "(0; no effective sabotage)"?

A. Infection was already 0 and cannot go lower. Similarly, at 12 an active round shows +0.

Q. Do the Mimics win if Infection is 10 but all Mimics have been scanned?

A. No. Scanning the last Mimic ends the game immediately with a crew win.

41.6 Voting and scanning

Q. Why was there no vote this round?

A. The X-ray was offline, the pool had fewer cells than the scan cost, or fewer than 2 players were alive. The vote panel says which.

Q. Is voting mandatory?

A. No. A player who does not vote casts no ballot.

Q. Can I vote for myself?

A. On a first ballot, yes (unless the host turned off `Allow self-vote`).

Q. Can I vote for a verified player?

A. No. Verified players are never on the ballot.

Q. Can eliminated players vote or be voted for?

A. Neither.

Q. How many times can I skip?

A. Once per game. It is spent when that ballot closes. Afterwards the tile says `SKIP USED`.

Q. If I choose SKIP but go BACK before locking in, is my skip spent?

A. No. Only a SKIP ballot that is still cast when the ballot closes is spent.

Q. Can I change my vote?

A. Before `LOCK IN`, yes (BACK). After locking in, not from the phone.

Q. What if SKIP ties with a player?

A. No scan. If SKIP is among the top choices, nobody is scanned.

Q. What if nobody votes?

A. On a first ballot, it counts as a skip: no scan. In a runoff, it counts as a tie: no scan.

Q. Who votes in a runoff?

A. Every living player except the tied candidates. SKIP is not available.

Q. What if the runoff ties?

A. No scan, no cells spent. There is no second runoff.

Q. Does a runoff cost cells?

A. Only a scan costs cells; a tie or skip costs nothing.

Q. How many scans per round?

A. At most one.

Q. Can we see who voted for whom?

A. Yes, on the vote panel while the result is shown, unless `Votes hidden` is on. It is not kept in the log.

Q. Why did the game-over screen appear straight away after the last scan?

A. When a scan finds the last Mimic, the game ends at that moment and the monitor goes directly to the game-over screen, which shows the result and the log.

Q. Can a scan be wrong?

A. No. The scanner always reveals the true role.

41.7 Screens and technical

Q. What does a faded name mean?

A. That player's phone is disconnected.

Q. What does the green tick mean?

A. The player was scanned and verified as crew.

Q. What does the struck-through red name with MIMIC mean?

A. A scanned, eliminated Mimic.

Q. Why does the locked-in counter lag?

A. It updates every 5 seconds on purpose, so nobody can link a change to a particular player.

Q. Why are the buttons in a different order each round?

A. The focus tiles and the WORK/SABO buttons are shuffled per player per round so that nobody can read choices from finger positions.

Q. Why do my taps sometimes not register?

A. Every phone screen ignores taps for 0.7 seconds after it appears.

Q. My phone went to sleep. Did I lose my seat?

A. No. It reconnects automatically when you open it again, as long as you use the same browser.

Q. Can I play on two devices?

A. No. Your seat is tied to the browser you joined with.

Q. Is there a player chat?

A. No, by design. Talk out loud. The only chat on the monitor is the bots' talk.

Q. Can bots hear us?

A. No. Bots only read the game state and each other.

Q. Is the game saved if the server restarts?

A. No. Everything is in memory; a restart ends every game.

Q. Is there sound in the game?

A. Only in the introduction comic. Phones never make sound or vibrate.

Q. Can the host change settings mid-game?

A. No. Settings freeze at START.

- Q.

Can the host pause a timed game?
- A.

No. For host-controlled pacing, use Manual steps (chosen before starting).

42. Settings and controls reference

42.1 All settings

See the full table in section 6.5. Summary of ranges: Mimics 1–4 · Reactor cap 1–8 · Scan cost 2–8 · Rounds 6–14 · Steal amount 1–4 · Sabotages Team/Each · Repair chance 30–80 % · Repair target 4–12 · Med bay seats 2–12 or unlimited · Repair cost 1–2 · Scrap per worker 1–3 · Starting scrap 0–6 · Starting cells 0–6 · Fuse length 2–5 · Allow self-vote on/off · Talk 30–600 s · Act 20–180 s · Vote 20–180 s · Report 5–60 s · Resolve 10–90 s. Modes: Manual steps, Votes hidden, Bot skill (Easy/Normal/Hard), Fast phases (dev).

42.2 Keyboard and controls

Where	Key	Action
Introduction comic	→ ←	Next / previous page
Introduction comic	Space	Pause / resume
Introduction comic	Esc	Skip
Host screen, manual steps	Space → Page Down	Next (a presentation clicker works)
Quit / close dialog	Esc	Cancel
Phone role card	Press and hold	Reveal while held

42.3 Addresses

Address	Screen
<code>/</code>	Main menu (and the introduction)
<code>/host/ABCD</code>	The monitor for game ABCD (host or watch-only)
<code>/play</code>	The phone screen after joining

43. Glossary

Term	Meaning
Act	The phase where players secretly choose a room, a focus and a button.
Arrival	The end of the final round, when the ship reaches the station and the Infection check decides the game.
Balance slider	Lobby control with five positions (Crew++ ... Mimic++) that sets the Reactor cap, scan cost and rounds.

Term	Meaning
Bot	A computer-controlled player seated by the host.
Break	A Mimic sabotage that sets the Reactor, Steering or Oxygen broken with a fuse.
Broken	State of a room that has been broken and not repaired. It has a fuse.
Cap (Reactor cap)	The most power cells the Reactor can produce in one round.
Corrupt	A Mimic sabotage in the Med bay that makes one paid repair attempt fail.
Crew	The human role. Wins by scanning every Mimic or arriving with Infection below 10.
Crew chat	The monitor tab showing what bots say.
Effective sabotage	A sabotage that actually changed something (section 14.2). Raises Infection by 2 (once per round).
Eliminated	A scanned Mimic, out of the game and in spectator view.
Focus	The second choice in Act: your room or a connected room. Used only by a Mimic's SABO.
Fuse	The countdown on a broken room. At 0 the ship is lost.
Host	The browser that created the game; it can start, configure, advance and quit it.
Hull breach	A fuse reaching 0. The Mimics win.
Infection	The shared 0–12 meter. Mimics need 10+ at arrival.
Lobby	The waiting screen before START, where players join and settings are chosen.
Lock in	Confirming an action or a vote on the phone.
Manual steps	A mode with no timers; the host presses Next.
Mimic	The hidden alien role that sabotages the ship.
Monitor	The shared screen showing the game.
Pipe	A connection between two rooms that sets sabotage range.
Pool	The ship's shared stock of scrap or power cells.
Power cell	Resource made in the Reactor; spent on scans.
Quiet round	A round without effective sabotage. Infection – 1.
Relay screening	The station's defence that destroys Mimics on arrival if Infection is below 10.
Repair (room)	Fixing a broken room by working in it.
Repair attempt	One Med bay worker's try at adding a point to the X-ray track.
Repair track / progress	X-ray repair points, 0 to 6. At 6 the X-ray is online.
Report	The first phase of each round, and the per-room summaries shown on the map.
Resolve	The phase where the server applies all actions and reveals the result.
Room code	The 4-letter code that identifies a game.
Runoff	A second ballot between players tied on the first one.

Term	Meaning
SABO	One of the two action buttons. Sabotage for a Mimic (if valid), work for crew.
Scan	Firing the X-ray at the voted player, revealing their true role.
Scrap	Resource made in the Cargo bay; spent on repair attempts.
Settings line	The one-line summary of the game's settings.
SKIP	A ballot choice meaning no scan. Usable once per player per game.
Smash	A Mimic sabotage that removes a repair point from the online X-ray.
Spectator view	The eliminated player's phone screen, showing all roles and last round's actions.
Steal / theft	A Mimic sabotage destroying 2 scrap (Cargo bay) or 2 cells (Reactor).
Talk	The discussion phase.
Team / Each	The two "Sabotages" settings: one sabotage per round for the team, or every Mimic's sabotage lands.
Verified	A crew member proven by a scan. Removed from future ballots.
Votes hidden	A mode where ballots are never shown, only outcomes.
WORK	The other action button: normal work in your room.
X-ray	The Med bay scanner. Must be repaired to be used; can be smashed once online.

End of the MIMIC user guide.